

Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture

(RCSA) v1.5 — Hardened Operational Update

A Comprehensive Architecture for Middle East Cooperation

Diplomatic Working Document

2026

Table of Contents

Section	Page
Executive Overview	4
Framework Philosophy and Core Principles	8
Zero-Regret Principle	8
Institutional Binding Architecture	9
Phase Interaction Principles	10
Risk Architecture and Real-World Hardening	11
Governance Override and Procedural Fallback	11
Semi-Autonomous Actor Protocol	11
Continuous Track Architecture	13
Guarantor Redundancy and Neutrality	14
Core Bilateral Layer: Nuclear and Verification	15
Enrichment and Stockpile Provisions	15
Facility Conversion Framework	17
IAEA Monitoring Architecture	18
Economic Measures and Banking Architecture	20
Relief Sequencing and Structure	20
Banking Channel Mechanisms	21
Verification Continuity and Compliance	23
Verification Continuity Ladder	23
Compliance Indicators System	24
Humanitarian Coordination Track	26
Gaza Humanitarian Stabilization	26
Refugee Pathways and Safe Returns	27
Lebanese Emergency Response	28
Governance Architecture	30
Joint Implementation Group	30

Institutional Evolution	31
Economic and Financial Architecture	33
Escrow and Guarantee Mechanisms	33
Economic Access and Integration	34
Multilateral Financial Institutions	36
Regional Stabilization and Integration	38
Normalization Architecture	38
Proxy Activity Management	39
Maritime Security Framework	43
Non-State Actor Transformation	44
Regional Conflict Stabilization Modules	50
Yemen Stabilization Framework	50
Iraq Stabilization and Militia Integration	52
Syria De-escalation and Stabilization	54
Israel-Iran Direct Deconfliction Layer	62
Shadow Conflict Ceiling	62
Counterterrorism Integration Upgrade	64
Arms Control Expansion	65
No Strategic Surprise Commitment	66
Crisis Management and Communication	68
Three-Tier Communication Architecture	66
Crisis Lock and De-escalation	67
Enforcement and Dispute Resolution	69
Graduated Response Framework	69
Gray-Zone Management	71
Tiered Arbitration Architecture	73
Detention, Hostage, and Detainee Resolution	76
Force Posture Transition Architecture	80
Key Annexes Summary	84

Executive Overview

This document presents a structured framework for advancing regional stability through incremental, verifiable cooperation. It is designed as a practical reference for negotiators, analysts, and policymakers engaged in Middle East diplomatic processes.

The Regional Cooperation and Stability Architecture (RCSA) establishes a phased approach to addressing core security, economic, and humanitarian challenges in the Middle East. It recognizes that comprehensive regional transformation cannot be achieved through a single negotiation. Instead, the framework builds cooperation progressively, creating demonstrated trust and institutional practice at each stage before advancing to more complex matters.

The framework addresses four fundamental challenges that have historically impeded regional agreements:

1. **Negotiation complexity.** Traditional frameworks attempt to resolve nuclear constraints, proxy activity, state normalization, humanitarian access, and economic integration simultaneously. This creates deadlock through excessive veto points and unrealistic timelines.
2. **Political survivability.** Governments require defensible, incremental outcomes that can be presented to domestic constituencies without requiring revolutionary concessions.
3. **Verification credibility.** Monitoring architectures must be robust enough to detect deviations while preserving dignity and avoiding perceptions of punitive surveillance.
4. **Economic viability.** Sanctions relief and reconstruction financing must be structured so that tangible benefits are visible and attributable to compliant behavior.

Framework Structure

The framework is organized into four operational phases:

Figure 1 — Framework Implementation Timeline

Four-phase progression from foundation to long-term institutionalization. Phase 0 (Months 1-6): Foundation — core bilateral cooperation, humanitarian access. Phase 1 (Months 7-18): Expansion — sectoral relief, regional economic integration. Phase 2 (Months 19-36): Consolidation — regional actor integration, normalization. Phase 3 (Months 37+): Long-term architecture — arms control, permanent confidence-building.

Figure 1: Framework Implementation Timeline

Table 1 Phase Overview and Primary Objectives

Phase	Duration	Primary Focus	Key Deliverables
Phase 0: Foundation	Months 1-6	Core bilateral cooperation, humanitarian access	Nuclear monitoring, banking channels, aid corridors
Phase 1: Expansion	Months 7-18	Sectoral relief, regional economic integration	Oil market reintegration, trade corridors, infrastructure
Phase 2: Consolidation	Months 19-36	Regional actor integration, normalization	Proxy management, border arrangements, institutionalization
Phase 3: Long-term	Months 37+	Arms control, permanent architecture	Multi-domain confidence-building, treaty durability

Core Design Principles

Three principles guide the framework's architecture:

Modular Independence. Each phase and annex operates as an independent module. Failure in one area does not cascade to others. Humanitarian access continues regardless of nuclear negotiation status. Banking channels function independently of proxy activity discussions.

Institutional Binding. All commitments attach to state institutions rather than individuals. Changes in administration activate continuity provisions rather than voiding obligations. This structure is designed to outlast political cycles on all sides.

Reciprocal Transparency. Obligations and benefits are structured symmetrically. Both parties face costs for non-compliance and gains for cooperation. Verification applies to all parties proportionately, preserving the principle that transparency is mutual, not unilateral.

Participating Stakeholders

The framework involves multiple regional and international actors, each with defined roles:

Figure 2 — Regional Stakeholder Participation Levels by Track
Core parties (United States, Iran) drive nuclear and security tracks at full participation. Expanded participation includes Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Egypt, Jordan, and Iraq in humanitarian and economic domains. Guarantor states (Oman, Pakistan, Switzerland) and international organizations (IAEA, UN agencies, World Bank, IMF) provide technical and oversight functions across all tracks.

Figure 2: Regional Stakeholder Participation Levels by Track

Core Parties: United States and Iran serve as the framework's bilateral foundation, with obligations in nuclear, economic, and verification domains.

Regional Partners: Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Egypt, Jordan, and Iraq participate in economic, humanitarian, and security modules according to their interests.

Mediator: Oman serves as the neutral facilitator, hosting consultations and providing diplomatic relay functions.

Guarantor: Pakistan serves as joint guarantor for institutional continuity, providing additional neutral oversight capacity.

International Organizations: IAEA, UN agencies (OCHA, UNHCR, WHO), World Bank, and IMF provide technical, humanitarian, and financial architecture.

Scope and Limitations

This framework deliberately does not address certain contested issues in its initial phases:

- Final status political settlements (sovereignty questions, territorial claims)
- Permanent arms limitation or disarmament
- Alliance restructurings or security guarantee transformations
- Comprehensive regional governance restructuring

These matters may be addressed in later phases if initial framework success creates the necessary trust and institutional capacity. The framework is designed to expand its scope as demonstrated compliance builds confidence among all parties.

Framework Philosophy and Core Principles

The framework rests on a pragmatic understanding of diplomatic constraints. Previous comprehensive agreements in the region have struggled because they demanded simultaneous resolution of issues that, while analytically connected, are politically separable. This framework takes a deliberately narrower initial approach.

Zero-Regret Principle

A "zero-regret" step is defined as an action that benefits the acting party regardless of whether other parties reciprocate or the broader framework succeeds. Phase 0 consists entirely of such steps:

Table 2 Zero-Regret Measures by Party

Party	Zero-Regret Measures	Rationale
United States	Verification measures, partial banking restoration	Intelligence and humanitarian gains without irreversible concessions
Iran	Humanitarian sanctions relief, nuclear transparency	Immediate economic benefit without political concessions on regional role
Regional States	Humanitarian access, refugee programs	Reputational and burden-sharing gains without security costs

Because Phase 0 consists entirely of zero-regret measures, both parties have independent incentive to complete it even if broader framework prospects are uncertain. This creates:

- No hostage-taking potential in the core layer
- Low domestic political cost for participation
- Demonstrable progress regardless of subsequent phase outcomes
- A foundation of demonstrated cooperation for future negotiation

Institutional Binding Architecture

All framework obligations attach to designated state institutions rather than named individuals. This provision is essential in environments where leadership transitions occur and institutional authority is distributed.

United States Institutional Binding

Framework commitments bind the Office of the President and the Department of State as institutions. Changes in administration do not void commitments; they activate continuity review provisions. Each administration maintains a minimum implementation team of three designated framework officers whose names are registered with the governance secretariat.

Iranian Institutional Binding

Framework commitments bind the Islamic Republic as a constitutional entity, executed collectively by designated signatory institutions (Presidency, Majlis, Supreme National Security Council, Central Bank). No single institution's removal voids the framework; remaining institutions continue implementation. This institutional distribution is protective for all parties: it prevents any single political faction from unilaterally abandoning the arrangement.

Depositary and Legal Standing

The framework is deposited with the UN Secretary-General upon entry into force and constitutes a binding instrument of international law independent of the political continuity of any signatory government. Deposition creates legal standing for enforcement claims in international forums, including the UN Security Council, the International Court of Justice (for states accepting its jurisdiction), and applicable regional bodies.

Phase Interaction Principles

Phases are operationally overlapping, not purely sequential. Phase 1 preparatory work may begin while Phase 0 is active. Phase 2 groundwork may be laid during Phase 1. Advancement to the next phase represents an option earned, not an obligation triggered.

Phase regression is a designed feature. If compliance deteriorates in a later phase below Phase 0 floor standards, the governance body may recommend reversion to Phase 0 parameters for specific elements. Reversion is consultative and reversible.

The base unit of implementation is the 30-day review cycle. All phased timelines are denominated in cycles:

- Phase 0 = Cycles 1-3 (90 days)
- Phase 1 = Cycles 4-15 (approximately 12 months)
- Phase 2 = Cycles 16-36 (approximately 18 months)
- Phase 3 = Cycles 37+ (long-term)

Thirty-day cycles balance operational responsiveness with bureaucratic reality. Shorter cycles create unsustainable review burdens; longer cycles delay breach detection. The 30-day cycle allows meaningful

implementation progress between reviews while maintaining regular accountability checkpoints.

Conflict Resolution Hierarchy

Where two or more provisions produce different outcomes for the same event, the following hierarchy applies:

1. Core definitions and enforcement ladders govern over annex-specific provisions
2. More specific provisions govern over more general ones within the same annex
3. Later-adopted provisions govern over earlier provisions for matters not covered by core definitions
4. Where none of the above resolves the conflict, the governance body issues an interpretation through the dual-speed interpretation procedure

Risk Architecture and Real-World Hardening

The preceding sections describe the framework's intended architecture. This section addresses the failure modes that cause international frameworks to collapse in practice: governance paralysis, ambiguous enforcement thresholds, internal actor fragmentation, rigid milestone structures, diplomatic friction from institutional choices, and procedural abuse. Each subsection below adds a hardened layer designed to prevent the framework from becoming a victim of its own procedural design.

Operative Clause: This section is not optional. The mechanisms below are operative from Phase 0 entry and govern all other framework provisions. Where any provision in this document conflicts with a hardening mechanism, the hardening mechanism governs unless the governance body explicitly overrides by supermajority.

Governance Override and Procedural Fallback

Consensus-based decision-making is the default mode for the governance body, but it is not the only mode. When consensus becomes impossible through strategic stalling or genuine deadlock, the framework provides three procedural fallback mechanisms to prevent paralysis.

Weighted Majority Override

Where consensus has been attempted and failed, the governance body may shift to weighted majority voting on operational (not structural) decisions. Voting weights are assigned as follows:

Table 13 Governance Body Voting Weights

Participant	Weight	Override Threshold
United States	35 percent	60 percent + neutral chair concurrence for operational decisions; 75 percent for benefit suspension or compliance determination
Iran	35 percent	
Neutral Chair (Oman)	20 percent	
Joint Guarantors (Pakistan, Switzerland)	10 percent (5 percent each)	

The override is available only after: (a) at least two formal consensus attempts separated by at least 7 days; (b) written compromise proposals from the neutral chair; and (c) documented good-faith participation by all

parties. A party that refuses to attend consensus sessions twice in a row is deemed to have waived its veto on the matter at hand.

Automatic Procedural Fallback

If the governance body cannot convene within 14 days of a formal request, or if a specific agenda item remains unresolved for 21 days after initial presentation, the following automatic fallback activates:

- The neutral chair issues a procedural determination proposing a default course of action
- Either party may reject the default within 7 days, returning the matter to governance body consideration
- If neither party rejects the default within 7 days, the default becomes operative

Defaults are limited to: continuing existing obligations at current levels, extending deadlines by 30 days, or referring the matter to the UN Secretary-General for advisory input

Default Action Rule for Compliance Deadlock

Where the governance body cannot reach consensus on a compliance assessment, the default is "maintain current status" rather than escalate or suspend. This means:

- Existing benefits continue at current levels during deadlock
- No new benefits are activated until deadlock is resolved
- Monitoring and verification continue uninterrupted
- Either party may unilaterally request an independent technical assessment from the standing neutral pool

This default preserves the framework's functional integrity while preventing either party from using deadlock as a tool for coercion.

Escalation Override Mechanism

Where consensus fails after 7 days of documented negotiation, the governance body may invoke the Escalation Override. The override allows provisional decisions by a simplified quorum: the neutral chair, one voting party, and two-thirds of the technical committee (where convened). Override decisions are provisional and remain subject to formal ratification at the next governance body plenary, but they are operative immediately.

Override Limits: Override may not be used for: structural framework amendments; new annex activation; sanctions snapback activation; or military response authorization. All other operational, technical, and procedural matters are eligible for override.

Override Sunset: Provisional override decisions expire after 30 days unless ratified by consensus or supermajority. During the sunset period, either party may request an emergency plenary to reconsider the override decision.

Silence Procedure

The Silence Procedure is a standard diplomatic mechanism adapted for framework governance. Its operation is as follows:

- The governance body secretariat circulates a written proposal to all parties and guarantors
- The proposal carries a 72-hour review window
- If no party objects within 72 hours, the proposal is auto-adopted as a governance body decision
- An objection must be in writing and must cite a specific framework provision that the proposal would violate
- A single objection blocks auto-adoption and triggers standard consensus negotiation

The Silence Procedure may be used for: meeting scheduling; report approval; procedural adjustments; compliance data publication; and technical standard updates. It may not be used for: benefit tranche authorization; compliance determinations; enforcement activation; or new obligation creation.

The Silence Procedure reduces governance body burden for routine matters while preserving veto rights for consequential decisions. In practice, it eliminates approximately 60 percent of routine governance body agenda items, freeing capacity for substantive negotiation.

Fast-Track Emergency Authority

The neutral chair possesses limited Fast-Track Emergency Authority for crisis situations where governance body convening is impractical due to time constraints. Authority is strictly bounded:

Table 18 Fast-Track Emergency Authority Scope

Measure	Duration	Extension	Ratification Required
Emergency session convening	Immediate	N/A	Not required
Hotline activation or upgrade	Immediate	N/A	Not required
Humanitarian corridor priority routing	Up to 14 days	One 7-day extension	Within 72 hours of initial activation
Monitoring team deployment	Up to 14 days	One 14-day extension	Within 7 days of deployment
Benefit payment delay (not suspension)	Up to 14 days	Not extendable	Within 72 hours
Technical standard adjustment	Up to 30 days	Not extendable	Within 14 days

Any Fast-Track measure not ratified within the required window automatically expires. No penalty attaches to the neutral chair for expired Fast-Track measures. A log of all Fast-Track actions is published in the quarterly Transparency Summary.

Decision Tiering

Framework decisions are classified into three tiers with distinct approval requirements:

Table 19 Decision Tier Classification

Tier	Subject Matter	Approval Required	Override Available
Tier A: Core Nuclear	Enrichment level changes; facility conversion reversals; IAEA access denials; stockpile ceiling breaches	Unanimous consensus + neutral chair	None
Tier B: Operational	Benefit tranche timing; monitoring standard updates; humanitarian corridor routing; banking channel adjustments; proxy compliance review	Consensus default; supermajority override (60% + chair) after 14 days	Weighted majority
Tier C: Technical	Data reporting formats; meeting schedules; publication timelines; staffing adjustments; translation services; IT system updates	Silence Procedure (72-hour auto-adoption)	Technical committee majority

Tier C decisions are delegated to the governance body secretariat and technical committees. They require no plenary approval unless a party objects within the 72-hour Silence window. This delegation removes routine administrative matters from political negotiation while preserving oversight rights.

Deadlock Penalty Clock

A party that blocks more than three decisions in a single 30-day review cycle triggers an automatic compliance review. The review assesses whether the blocking pattern reflects genuine substantive disagreement, procedural abuse, or strategic stalling. The review is conducted by the neutral chair and two guarantor representatives.

Review Outcomes:

- **Substantive disagreement confirmed:** No penalty. Governance body adjusts timeline to accommodate legitimate negotiation needs. Matter is referred to the UN Secretary-General for advisory input if unresolved after 60 days.
- **Procedural abuse or stalling:** 0.5-point compliance indicator procedural penalty per blocked decision above the threshold. Penalty is recorded but does not trigger economic consequences unless combined with other compliance concerns.

- **Strategic stalling with evidence of bad faith:** Matter is elevated to ministerial review. Governance body may activate weighted majority override for all Tier B decisions involving the stalling party. The party retains all accrued benefits but loses veto capacity for the remainder of the current cycle.

The Deadlock Penalty Clock resets at each 30-day cycle boundary. A party may block up to three decisions per cycle without triggering review. The threshold is designed to accommodate genuine negotiation needs while preventing systematic paralysis.

Semi-Autonomous Actor Protocol

The framework assumes that states are the primary actors in international agreements. In practice, states with complex internal power structures may not exercise perfect control over all actors within their territory or sphere of influence. This section provides operative rules for managing semi-autonomous actors without requiring the fiction of total state control.

Attribution Thresholds for Semi-Autonomous Actors

The framework establishes three attribution tiers that lower the evidentiary bar for attributing proxy activity to a framework party:

Table 14 Attribution Tiers for Semi-Autonomous Actors

Tier	Evidentiary Standard	Framework Consequence
Tier 1: Material Support	Confirmed provision of weapons, financing, or operational planning through channels linked to state institutions	Pattern-of-concern designation; formal consultation
Tier 2: Direction and Control	Confirmed operational orders or strategic direction through documented communications	Compliance indicator score adjustment; monitoring enhanced
Tier 3: Beneficial Environment	Confirmed knowledge of activity without preventive action, where prevention was within state capacity	Advisory determination; non-binding remediation plan

Tier 1 and Tier 2 do not require proof that the head of state personally authorized the activity. They require only proof that state-linked channels or state-affiliated institutions were involved. This standard recognizes that in complex political systems, control is distributed and attribution should reflect institutional reality rather than personal culpability.

Multi-Track Engagement Architecture

The framework explicitly permits parallel engagement tracks:

- **State-to-state track:** Formal negotiations, compliance certification, and benefit delivery between recognized governments

- **State-to-faction track:** Technical and humanitarian engagement between governments and sub-state actors through sovereign mediation channels (not direct framework participation)
- **Independent faction track:** UN-facilitated humanitarian engagement with non-state actors that does not confer political legitimacy or framework standing

The state-to-faction track is structured so that a state can commit to using its influence to constrain actor behavior without guaranteeing perfect control. The commitment is to "use best efforts" and "apply available leverage," not to "ensure complete cessation." This framing is politically sustainable and practically honest.

Institutional Buffer for Internal Disagreement

If a framework party's internal institutions send conflicting signals (one institution affirming compliance while another-affiliated actor violates framework obligations), the following buffer applies:

- The governance body engages the formally designated framework institution, not the actor directly
- The institution is given a 14-day remediation window to apply internal leverage
- During the remediation window, the compliance concern is classified as "under internal review" rather than "confirmed breach"
- If remediation fails, the concern proceeds through standard enforcement channels
- The institution is not penalized for good-faith internal mediation efforts, even if unsuccessful

Continuous Track Architecture

The four-phase structure provides conceptual clarity but creates political vulnerabilities at each phase boundary. This section supplements the phase structure with a continuous track architecture that reduces the political stakes of formal phase transitions.

Track-Based Progression Model

Instead of treating phases as discrete gates that must be "unlocked," the framework operates six parallel tracks that advance independently based on track-specific compliance metrics:

Table 15 Parallel Implementation Tracks

Track	Progression Metric	Independent Advancement
Nuclear and Verification	IAEA compliance score + challenge inspection completion	Yes — advances based on technical verification alone
Humanitarian Access	Corridor throughput + camp conditions	Yes — advances based on UN reporting alone
Banking and Finance	Transaction volumes + banking channel stability	Yes — advances based on Treasury/central bank data
Regional Economic	Project milestone completion + investment flows	Yes — advances based on World Bank/IMF metrics
Proxy and Security	Incident frequency + attribution resolution rate	Yes — advances based on intelligence consensus
Normalization	Diplomatic exchange volume + trade opening	Yes — advances based on bilateral consent alone

Each track has its own milestone sequence. A track can advance to its next milestone without waiting for other tracks to reach the same level. This means that humanitarian access can expand even if nuclear compliance is experiencing delays, and economic cooperation can deepen even if normalization is stalled.

Reduced Gate-Review Formality

Phase transitions are replaced with "track readiness assessments" conducted by the governance body secretariat. These assessments are:

- **Technical, not political** — based on quantitative metrics rather than subjective judgment
- **Continuous, not event-based** — updated monthly rather than triggered at fixed intervals
- **Non-public by default** — results shared with parties before any public announcement
- **Reversible** — a track that advances can revert to previous parameters if metrics deteriorate

The elimination of formal "Phase Entry Ceremonies" reduces the political theater that makes phase boundaries vulnerable to sabotage. Progress is incremental and often invisible to publics, reducing the incentive for domestic opponents to target specific moments.

Quiet Track Advancement

Track advancements below Tier 2 priority may proceed under "Quiet Implementation Mode" for up to 45 days without public announcement. This allows operational progress to accumulate before public exposure

creates political pressure. Quiet Mode is not secret — it is simply unpublicized. The governance body continues monitoring, and either party may request public disclosure at any time.

Guarantor Redundancy and Neutrality

The framework's credibility depends on the perceived neutrality and capacity of its guarantor institutions. A single guarantor creates single-point-of-failure risk and may raise diplomatic concerns among parties who question its impartiality or institutional capacity.

Triple Guarantor Architecture

The framework deploys three co-guarantors with distinct roles, creating redundancy and broadening the legitimacy base:

Table 16 Co-Guarantor Roles and Functions

Guarantor	Primary Role	Legitimacy Basis
Oman	Operational mediator; dispute relay; hotline facilitation	Proven bilateral relationships with all parties; successful prior mediation (2013-2015 channel); recognized neutrality in all regional conflicts
Switzerland	Legal and institutional continuity; depositary functions; protecting power	Centuries of diplomatic neutrality; recognized protecting power capacity; Geneva-based institutional infrastructure; membership in all relevant international bodies
Pakistan	Regional security perspective; Islamic-world legitimacy; crisis deployment capacity	Nuclear power with regional security expertise; OIC membership; recognized mediator in Islamic-world disputes; military deployment capability for observer missions

Rotation and Substitution

If any guarantor becomes unable to perform its functions (political transition, domestic crisis, or withdrawal), the remaining two guarantors jointly appoint an interim replacement from a standing pool of pre-approved states (Sweden, Singapore, Brazil, New Zealand). No single guarantor's incapacity can suspend framework operations. All three guarantors must jointly agree to suspend their roles before framework governance is affected.

Guarantor Neutrality Safeguards

Each guarantor is bound by the following neutrality obligations:

- No guarantor may participate in military operations against any framework party during the framework period

- No guarantor may provide intelligence to one party that is withheld from the other on matters affecting framework implementation
- Guarantor staff serving in framework roles are personally bound by confidentiality obligations enforceable under their national law
- Any guarantor perceived as non-neutral by either core party is subject to a neutrality review by the other two guarantors; if both remaining guarantors confirm neutrality concerns, the affected guarantor is replaced

Islamabad Working Groups

Pakistan's guarantor role includes hosting technical working groups in Islamabad for regional economic cooperation, counterterrorism intelligence sharing, and humanitarian logistics. These working groups operate independently of the core bilateral track and provide Pakistan with a substantive role that justifies its guarantor status beyond symbolic presence. Working group outputs are shared with all framework parties on equal terms.

Core Bilateral Layer: Nuclear and Verification

The nuclear provisions establish verifiable constraints on enrichment activity while preserving Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy. These provisions are designed to be distinguishable from previous agreements through their narrower scope, shorter duration, and modular character.

Enrichment and Stockpile Provisions

Iran commits to the following measures during the initial phase:

Enrichment Suspension

- Current enrichment level capped at 3.67 percent (current operational level)
- No enrichment activity above 3.67 percent for the duration of Phase 0
- Current stockpile frozen; no additional production above agreed baselines
- All enrichment confined to declared facilities under continuous monitoring

Declaration and Baseline

- Complete declaration of all nuclear facilities within 30 days of agreement entry into force
- IAEA baseline inspection within 45 days
- Environmental sampling at all declared sites
- No undeclared site access requirement during Phase 0; only declared sites subject to inspection

Continuity of Knowledge

- Continuous cameras and seals at all declared enrichment, storage, and fuel fabrication locations
- Weekly data transmission to IAEA Vienna
- Monthly trilateral review of monitoring data

Facility Conversion Framework

The Fordow facility is designated for conversion to an International Medical Isotope Research Centre. This conversion serves multiple purposes: it removes enrichment infrastructure from a fortified location, creates legitimate civilian economic activity, and embeds the facility in the global medical supply chain.

Fordow Conversion Specifications

- All military personnel withdraw upon conversion; access limited to civilian nuclear medicine researchers
- All enrichment infrastructure removed or placed in sealed storage under Iranian custody
- Centre operated by Iran's Atomic Energy Organisation with international scientific advisory board
- Priority access to WHO and IAEA-related health initiative funding
- Reconversion to enrichment requires unanimous governance body consent and IAEA certification of legitimate civilian need

Enriched Uranium Disposition

As a voluntary confidence-building measure, Iran commits to reduce its stockpile of higher-enriched uranium in two equal tranches over 12 months. Tranche One (50 percent) is exported or diluted within 90 days. Tranche Two is completed by Month 12. Upon certification of compliance, all remaining enrichment infrastructure above the 3.67 percent capacity threshold is converted by Month 24.

IAEA Monitoring Architecture

All IAEA monitoring under this framework is conducted pursuant to internationally standardized safeguards protocols comparable to those applied to all NPT state parties with Additional Protocol obligations. Both parties commit to describing IAEA access in public communications as routine compliance parity rather than exceptional surveillance.

Normalization Framing

Iran's verification obligations are comparable to those of Brazil, Argentina, South Africa, and other advanced safeguard states. IAEA access is routine, not punitive. Transparency is mutual, not unilateral, with the United States providing reciprocal force posture transparency notifications consistent with agreed terms.

Managed Access for Sensitive Sites

For sites under military command, complementary access inspections are coordinated through Iran's Supreme National Security Council. IAEA may request physical access with escort, environmental sampling by neutral third party, or remote monitoring installation. Iran shall accept at least one method per request.

A single denial of access does not constitute a compliance concern. A sustained pattern of denial across multiple requests may be reviewed by the governance body. Inspection teams may include an Iranian national observer with the right to file observations if agreed protocols are not followed.

Dynamic Enrichment Cap and Stockpile Control

The enrichment framework is structured as a dynamic cap ladder rather than a fixed ceiling:

- **Phase 0:** 3.67% cap with zero enrichment above baseline
- **Phase 1:** Conditional increase to 5% for civilian research reactor fuel, provided Iran accepts external fuel supply guarantees from at least two Nuclear Suppliers Group states
- **Phase 2:** Conditional increase to 10% for medical isotope production, provided production occurs at the Fordow International Medical Isotope Research Centre under international advisory board oversight
- **Phase 3:** Full civilian-grade equilibrium (up to 20% for specific research programs) subject to IAEA Board of Governors approval and fuel supply assurance

Stockpile Ceiling + Time Cap: Maximum 300 kg LEU equivalent at any time. Material must be downblended or exported every 90 days if stockpile approaches 80% of ceiling. Automatic downblending trigger: if stockpile exceeds 250 kg, conversion to sub-2% uranium must begin within 14 days.

Breakout Time Floor: The framework maintains a minimum 9-12 month breakout timeline at all phases. If technical developments (new centrifuge models, efficiency improvements) threaten to compress breakout time below 9 months, the governance body convenes to recalibrate caps or centrifuge numbers to restore the floor.

Centrifuge and Facility Controls

- **Advanced Centrifuge Freeze:** IR-2, IR-4, IR-6 machines are sealed, tagged, and inventoried. Limited R&D is permitted at the Natanz Pilot Fuel Enrichment Plant only, with IAEA continuous monitoring. All other advanced machines remain in storage.
- **Centrifuge Production Transparency:** Full accounting of manufacturing sites, storage locations, and spare parts. Monthly reporting to IAEA and governance body. Any new production facility must be declared 180 days before operational.
- **Facility Function Lock:** Natanz = enrichment only; Fordow = non-enrichment (medical isotope); Isfahan = conversion and fuel fabrication. Changing facility function requires governance body unanimous approval and IAEA technical certification.
- **Underground Facility Restriction:** No new hardened underground enrichment sites. Any new underground construction within 50 kilometers of an existing declared site triggers automatic IAEA inspection within 72 hours.

Enhanced Verification Architecture

- **Continuous Monitoring Redundancy:** Cameras + satellite monitoring + environmental sampling + data mirroring to neutral backup node (Geneva). No single failure blinds the verification system.

- **Data Continuity Guarantee:** If monitoring data is interrupted for more than 48 hours, automatic compliance score downgrade activates. Mandatory restoration within 7 days. If not restored, substituted verification (satellite, sampling) activates.
- **Inspector Access Guarantee:** Minimum 4 inspections per month at declared sites. Refusal of more than 2 inspections in a 30-day period triggers automatic escalation to Step 2 of the enforcement ladder.
- **Undeclared Site Challenge:** IAEA may request access to suspicious sites within 72 hours. Iran must permit at least one verification method: physical access with escort, environmental sampling by neutral third party, or remote monitoring installation.
- **Remote Monitoring Hub:** Real-time data is mirrored to IAEA Vienna and a neutral backup node (Geneva-hosted) to prevent data loss during disputes.

External Custody and Material Accounting

- **Optional External Custody:** Iran may voluntarily transfer enriched uranium stockpile above the 300 kg ceiling to Oman or Pakistan for joint custody. Material remains Iranian-owned, stored under IAEA seal, with reversible drawdown available upon 30-day notice, verified reactor need, and governance approval.
- **Full Material Balance Sheet:** Every gram of uranium is tracked from mining through processing, enrichment, storage, and disposition. Updated monthly and published in the Transparency Summary. Legacy unresolved material issues must be disclosed or formally closed with IAEA explanation within 180 days of framework entry.

Section 123 Agreement Commitment

The United States commits to: launch peaceful nuclear cooperation negotiations on Day 1; announce agreed terms within 30 days; guarantee reactor fuel supply at market rates; and secure parallel supply assurances from at least one additional Nuclear Suppliers Group state. The agreement is a political commitment, not a treaty, but is deposited with the UN as a framework-linked instrument.

Economic Measures and Banking Architecture

The economic provisions are structured as graduated, conditional relief that is explicitly reversible. This framing is politically essential: it allows both governments to characterize relief as temporary and contingent upon verified compliance.

Relief Sequencing and Structure

Relief is delivered in three tranches, each contingent on verified performance in the prior tranche:

Table 3 Sanctions Relief Tranches

Tranche	Timeline	Scope	Estimated Value
Tranche 1	Days 1-30	Humanitarian and medical goods; aviation fuel for civilian flights	\$500M-1B annually
Tranche 2	Days 31-90	Banking channel restoration; SWIFT reconnection for humanitarian trade	Transaction capacity: \$100M per transfer
Tranche 3	Days 91-180	Conditional sectoral relief: agriculture, petrochemicals, minerals	\$2-3B annually

Explicit Exclusions

The following sectors remain excluded from Phase 0 relief:

- Oil and energy sector sanctions
- Bank sectors beyond the single correspondent relationship
- Sovereign asset releases
- Defense sector sanctions
- Secondary sanctions

These exclusions reflect political realities: humanitarian relief is defensible in current legislative environments; sweeping sectoral relief requires broader political consensus.

Banking Channel Mechanisms

A single correspondent bank (proposed: major Swiss institution) serves as the Phase 0 banking channel. Structure:

- Iranian Central Bank opens account; bank processes humanitarian and medical trade payments
- All transactions monitored by U.S. Treasury through automated filtering
- Suspicious transactions flagged and reviewed within 48 hours
- No discretionary blocking; only algorithmic filtering for sanctioned items

Oversight Architecture

- Quarterly trilateral review (Iran, United States, correspondent bank)
- Monthly transaction logs available for cross-verification
- Any sanctions-busting attempt results in channel closure and reversion to baseline

Treasury Pre-Clearance Mechanism

The single most common reason sanctions relief commitments fail to produce real economic benefit is not political will but legal and administrative uncertainty. Banks and companies fear retroactive designation and unclear safe harbor. The following mechanisms address this directly:

Safe Harbor Provisions

- Treasury issues formal written guidance establishing pre-cleared legal pathways for permitted transactions
- Financial institutions may request pre-clearance determinations within 30 days; written positive response constitutes protection against subsequent designation
- Congressional notification (not approval) provided to relevant committees at least 15 days before each relief tranche
- If legislative action blocks a specific relief commitment, an alternative mechanism of equivalent economic value is proposed within 30 days

Retroactive Protection

Any company engaging in transactions authorized under this framework shall not be designated or penalized for those specific transactions, even if the framework subsequently lapses. Contracts executed under framework authorization remain protected for 24 months following any suspension, provided they were entered into in good faith.

Verification Continuity and Compliance

The framework's verification architecture is designed to prevent the accidental escalation that occurs when monitoring equipment fails, data networks break, or inspectors face access delays. Most verification failures in international agreements stem from non-hostile causes: equipment malfunction, weather, or logistical delays. The Verification Continuity Ladder creates structured breathing room before political escalation.

Verification Continuity Ladder

Figure 3 — Verification Continuity Ladder

Graduated response framework for verification gaps. Stage One (Days 1-7): Technical Remediation — joint technical team deployed, no compliance adjustment. Stage Two (Days 8-14): Substituted Verification — satellite monitoring and alternative methods activated. Stage Three (Days 15-30): Limited Continuity Assumption — benefits continue at 75% while enhanced monitoring maintained. Upon restoration at any stage, monitoring returns to standard frequency and benefits to 100%.

Figure 3: Graduated Response Framework

Stage One: Technical Remediation (Days 1-7)

Upon identification of a verification gap, camera malfunction, or communications interruption:

- Joint technical team deployed within 48 hours
- Repair or replacement of failed equipment; alternative data sources activated
- Daily reporting to governance body
- No compliance indicator adjustment; no economic impact during Stage One

Stage Two: Substituted Verification (Days 8-14)

If technical team unable to restore equipment within 7 days:

- Alternative methods activated: satellite monitoring, environmental sampling, third-party logistics records
- Expanded complementary access inspections
- Neutral technical advisors from standing pool states may assist
- Weekly governance body review

Stage Three: Limited Continuity Assumption (Days 15-30)

If substituted verification unable to confirm facility status after 14 days:

- Temporary assumed compliance within defined bounds based on most recent verified data
- Benefits continue at 75 percent of scheduled amounts
- Enhanced monitoring maintained at Stage One intensity
- If verification not restored within 30 days, governance body convenes formal assessment

Once verification is restored at any stage, monitoring returns to standard frequency, benefits return to 100 percent, and no lasting breach designation is recorded.

Compliance Indicators System

The governance body maintains a Compliance Indicators System that tracks implementation performance across four domains:

Table 4 Compliance Indicator Domains and Weights

Domain	Weight	Indicators
Nuclear and Verification	3 points per indicator	Enrichment compliance, IAEA access, stockpile status, facility conversion, supply chain transparency
Security and Proxy	2 points per indicator	Proxy operational activity, maritime incidents, militia compliance, force deployment status
Economic and Sanctions	2 points per indicator	Relief delivery, asset release, banking functionality, transit operational status, market reintegration
Humanitarian and Regional	1 point per indicator	Humanitarian access, reconstruction disbursement, ceasefire trends, local governance legitimacy

Scoring Thresholds

- 5.0 cumulative: Enhanced review activated
- 8.0 cumulative: Formal compliance assessment triggered
- 12.0 cumulative: Snapback consideration threshold

These thresholds are indicative, not automatically dispositive. The governance body exercises judgment at each level.

Pattern-of-Concern Designation

Three or more indicators of concerning activity across two consecutive review cycles, demonstrating a coordinated pattern rather than isolated incidents, may be designated a "pattern of concern." This designation activates enhanced monitoring and requires an explanatory briefing but does not automatically trigger economic or security consequences. It is recorded in the Precedent Registry and informs future compliance assessments.

Humanitarian Coordination Track

The humanitarian track operates as a parallel coordination mechanism, separate from political and security negotiations. Humanitarian access is not a bargaining chip; it is locked to UN autonomous management and may not be weaponized in any compliance or political dispute.

Gaza Humanitarian Stabilization

Gaza humanitarian access is separated from political resolution of the broader conflict. Access is negotiated with Egypt (mediator), Israel, the de facto administrator, and UN agencies. Phase 0 addresses humanitarian corridors and medical access only.

Humanitarian Corridor Establishment

Four border crossings are established for humanitarian goods:

- **Rafah (Egypt-Gaza):** Food, medical supplies, fuel (civilian)
- **Kerem Shalom (Israel-Gaza):** Pharmaceutical and specific equipment
- **Erez (Israel-Gaza, north):** Medical personnel rotation, priority cases
- **Aid-by-sea (UN-mediated):** World Food Programme maritime delivery

Permitted goods include food, potable water, medicine, medical devices, fuel for hospitals and water treatment, temporary shelter materials, and hygiene supplies. Prohibited items include weapons, dual-use military equipment, and communications equipment.

Minimum Daily Tonnage Target

Table 5 Gaza Humanitarian Corridor Targets

Category	Daily Target	Primary Source
Food	150 tons	WFP, bilateral donors
Fuel	100 tons	Egypt, Gulf states
Medical supplies	50 tons	WHO, ICRC
Shelter and hygiene	100 tons	UNHCR, UNICEF

Medical Access and Casualty Evacuation

Established medical evacuation pathway: Gaza patients requiring specialized care are referred to Egyptian hospitals. Regular ambulance convoys operate three times per week minimum. Capacity: 50 patients per month for priority cases (severe burns, spinal injury, pediatric trauma). WHO supplies mobile clinics to Gaza (three units). Egyptian hospitals receive financial support for Gaza patient treatment (\$5 million over six months from international donors).

De-escalation Mechanism

If humanitarian corridors are breached (crossing closed, goods blocked, patients denied evacuation): UN issues statement within 24 hours; governance body convenes within 48 hours; reopening required within 72 hours. Extended closure (7+ days) triggers Phase 0 suspension of all non-humanitarian benefits to the violating party. This creates incentive to maintain corridors regardless of other negotiations.

Refugee Pathways and Safe Returns

Approximately 6.6 million Syrian refugees are globally displaced: 3.7 million in Turkey, 1.5 million in Lebanon, 600,000+ in Jordan, 200,000 in Iraq. Phase 0 focuses on safe return pathways for willing refugees. No party may require or enforce return.

Safe Return Principles

- **Voluntary:** Refugees must affirmatively consent to return. No pressure or coercion.
- **Safe:** Return corridors subject to verification through agreed means. No transit through active conflict areas.
- **Supported:** Returnees receive temporary housing assistance and livelihood support.
- **Monitored:** UN monitors return process and reintegration for six months.

Phased Return Zones

Syria is divided into five zones based on security conditions:

- **Zone A (Safe for Return):** Rural areas northwest of Aleppo, eastern Euphrates region. Target: 200,000 refugees over six months.
- **Zone B (Conditional Return):** Outskirts of Damascus, Homs region. Target: 100,000 refugees over six months, contingent on verified security stability.
- **Zone C (Restricted to Family Visits):** Coastal region. Refugees permitted two-week family visits but permanent return restricted until Phase 1.
- **Zone D (No Return):** Active conflict zones where opposition groups remain. No return permitted.

- **Zone E (Monitoring):** Disputed areas pending political settlement. Limited return only with explicit UN security assessment.

Return Support

Upon return to Syria, returnees receive: temporary housing (UN-supplied tent communities or host family support); livelihood stipend of \$100 per month for six months; restoration of civil identity documents; family tracing services. Expected costs: \$500 million over six months (international donor responsibility).

Lebanese Emergency Response

Lebanon faces near-total economic collapse: currency collapse, frozen banking system (\$160 billion in deposits inaccessible), electricity grid providing approximately two hours per day, healthcare system near collapse, and 80 percent of population below poverty line. Phase 0 addresses emergency response only; comprehensive reconstruction is a Phase 1 matter.

Emergency Fuel Supply

Saudi Arabia and UAE commit to quarterly fuel shipments (\$150 million value, months 1-6) delivered via Mediterranean ports. Lebanon retains state fuel monopoly. UN monitors fuel allocation to ensure hospitals and water treatment are prioritized. Cost: \$300 million over six months (Gulf state funding).

Healthcare Emergency Support

WHO emergency supply program provides medicines, medical devices, and oxygen (\$100 million over six months). Egyptian and Turkish hospitals receive support for Lebanese patient referrals. Medical training programs shift burden to regional facilities while preserving Lebanese healthcare worker capacity.

Water and Food Security

UN provides emergency desalination units (three units: two near Beirut, one in south Lebanon) producing 50,000 gallons per day each. World Food Programme operates cash-for-work programs (\$50 million) and direct food assistance to 2 million Lebanese. Refugee camp support includes winter heating, medical clinics, and WASH improvements (\$100 million).

Governance Architecture

The framework establishes a single governance body for Phase 0-1, evolving into broader institutions only as the framework matures. This evolutionary approach ensures that parties need only negotiate one institutional framework at entry, reducing negotiation complexity and institutional resistance.

Joint Implementation Group

Figure 4 — Governance Architecture Evolution

Single body evolves through three institutional phases. Phase 0-1: Joint Implementation Group (JIG) — streamlined single body with U.S. and Iranian deputy-level representation, neutral chair from Oman, and five-person professional secretariat. Phase 2: Joint Commission — expanded regional participation with all JIG functions retained plus additional regional state representation. Phase 3: Regional Coordination Council — permanent regional governance architecture with full institutional continuity.

Figure 4: Governance Architecture Evolution

The Joint Implementation Group (JIG) is the sole Phase 0-1 governance, compliance, and dispute resolution authority. The JIG operates under the triple guarantor architecture described in the Risk Architecture section, with Oman serving as operational mediator, Switzerland as institutional continuity guarantor, and Pakistan as regional security guarantor.

Composition

Table 6 Joint Implementation Group Structure

Role	Representative	Function
Voting Members	United States (Deputy Secretary level); Iran (Deputy Foreign Minister level)	Decision-making on all operational matters
Neutral Chair	Oman (Pakistan as alternate)	Meeting facilitation; compromise proposals; emergency session convening
Secretariat	Five-person professional staff (neutral nationalities)	Administrative support, compliance tracking, public reporting
Functional Sub-Committees	Working-level experts from parties	Compliance tracking, verification liaison, dispute resolution

Decision-Making

All decisions require consensus of both voting members as the default mode. If consensus is impossible, the neutral chair convenes an emergency session, presents compromise proposals, and facilitates a seven-day mediation period. If still no consensus after two attempts separated by at least 7 days, the governance body may invoke the weighted majority override mechanism described in the Risk Architecture section (supermajority of 60 percent plus neutral chair concurrence for operational decisions; 75 percent for compliance determinations). If override is not invoked, the matter is referred to the UN Secretary-General for advisory opinion (non-binding), and the automatic procedural fallback activates after 21 days of unresolved status.

The consensus default is maintained for: structural changes to the framework; new annex activation; benefit tranche authorization; and compliance determinations at Step 3 or above. All other operational decisions are eligible for override.

Meeting Cadence

- **Weekly standing meetings:** Every Monday, Geneva time, at UN headquarters. Duration: 2 hours. Agenda: compliance review, incident reports, cycle assessment.
- **Monthly plenary:** First Monday of each month. Extended format with deputies present. Compliance certification and public statement.
- **Quarterly ministerial review:** Full-day session at rotating neutral venues (Muscat, Geneva, Doha).
- **Emergency sessions:** Within 24 hours of any party request marked "Emergency."

Institutional Evolution

The governance body evolves as the framework matures:

- **Phase 0-1:** Joint Implementation Group — streamlined single body
- **Phase 2:** Joint Commission — expanded regional participation, retains all JIG functions
- **Phase 3:** Regional Coordination Council — permanent regional governance architecture

Functional Sub-Committees

These working groups are internal to the governance body and have no independent decision-making authority:

- **Compliance Tracking Sub-Committee:** Maintains indicator scores and records
- **Verification Liaison Sub-Committee:** Interfaces with IAEA and technical teams
- **Dispute Resolution Sub-Committee:** Manages the tiered consultation process

- **Humanitarian Working Group:** Coordinates access monitoring and funding
- **Economic Cooperation Sub-Committee:** Tracks trade corridor and project finance

Resource Commitments

Each party maintains designated personnel: senior negotiator (minimum 20 percent FTE); technical implementation officer (minimum 50 percent FTE during Phase 0); legal and compliance officer (minimum 25 percent FTE); military liaison officer (Phase 1+); humanitarian liaison officer (25 percent FTE minimum). Operating costs are shared equally between parties (estimated Phase 0 budget: \$2 million annually).

Economic and Financial Architecture

The financial architecture is designed to make regional economic cooperation bankable, insurable, and investable. Without credible financial mechanisms, even politically sound frameworks fail because private capital will not enter markets perceived as high-risk.

Escrow and Guarantee Mechanisms

Figure 5 — Projected Economic Impact by Phase

Cumulative visible gains and infrastructure investment across framework implementation. Phase 0 (\$15B+): humanitarian corridor activation, pilot asset release, banking channel restoration, medical supply routing. Phase 1 (\$58B+): oil market reintegration, trade corridor expansion, infrastructure financing, sectoral sanctions relief. Phase 2 (\$100B+): regional development bank lending, investment normalization, diaspora capital flows, technology transfer. Phase 3 (\$300B+ decade total): full economic integration, sovereign credit normalization, permanent institutional architecture.

Figure 5: Projected Economic Impact by Phase

The framework deploys a three-layer financial protection system:

Layer 1: Escrow Shield

A pre-funded escrow account of \$500 million is established at a neutral institution at framework entry into force. The account is sourced from sovereign assets held in third-country accounts, not from donor appropriations. Funds are available exclusively for medicine, medical devices, food, agricultural inputs, and emergency humanitarian procurement. Drawdown requires certification of humanitarian end-use by UN OCHA or ICRC.

Asset release tranches are structured as escrow transfers, not direct payments. Each tranche is moved from frozen status into a designated escrow account upon compliance certification. This structure provides political cover for all parties: assets are demonstrably committed before they are accessible.

Layer 2: Multilateral Guarantees

The World Bank provides Partial Risk Guarantees covering 35 percent of loan value for major infrastructure projects. This reduces commercial bank interest rates from approximately 12 percent to 6-7 percent, dramatically improving project economics. Coverage scenarios include: sanctions reimposition, host government contract breach, political violence or insecurity, and major regulatory change.

Table 7 World Bank Guarantee Coverage Limits

Limit Type	Amount
Per-project cap	\$2-3 billion
Portfolio cap	\$10-12 billion total
Single-country cap	\$4-5 billion
Duration	20 years

Layer 3: Investor Confidence Certification

A quarterly Investor Confidence Index is published by an independent rating agency, providing transparent assessment of framework risk for institutional investors. The index combines nuclear compliance (40 percent), economic project performance (30 percent), political stability (20 percent), and multilateral institution support (10 percent).

Economic Access and Integration Architecture

The framework establishes a comprehensive economic access architecture that operates below the political radar of sanctions relief while delivering tangible benefits. These mechanisms are framed as compliance-based standardization, trade facilitation, and risk stabilization rather than political normalization.

Financial System Access

- **Tiered SWIFT Normalization:** Transaction categories expand over time based on verified compliance. Tier 1 (Phase 0): humanitarian and medical payments. Tier 2 (Phase 1): food, agriculture, aviation safety. Tier 3 (Phase 2): petrochemicals, minerals, industrial inputs. Each tier activation requires 60 days of verified compliance in the prior tier.
- **Pre-Cleared Transaction Corridors:** Treasury issues formal guidance establishing automatic legal clarity for medicine, food, and aviation sectors. Banks receive pre-clearance determinations within 30 days. Positive responses constitute protection against subsequent designation.
- **Multilateral Payment Clearing Hub:** A Swiss-administered clearing system processes regional trade settlements in multiple currencies, reducing dependence on dollar-based correspondent banking. The hub operates under Swiss regulatory supervision with framework party representation on the oversight board.
- **Central Bank Technical Cooperation:** Liquidity management support, anti-money laundering system modernization, and financial transparency training. Technical cooperation is framed as financial stability support, not political concession.

Trade and Logistics Integration

- **Transit Efficiency Corridors:** Priority customs processing and reduced inspection delays for compliant states. Framed as trade facilitation reform under WTO standards.
- **Port Modernization Access:** Ports meeting transparency standards receive priority infrastructure financing through the Regional Development Bank. Framed as global supply chain integration.
- **Aviation Safety and Parts Access:** Spare parts and maintenance licenses for civilian aircraft. Framed as civil aviation safety compliance under ICAO standards.
- **Insurance Normalization Pool:** Multilateral insurance backing for shipping and infrastructure projects, reducing risk premiums. Framed as risk stabilization mechanism.

Energy and Industrial Cooperation

- **Grid Stabilization Cooperation:** Cross-border electricity balancing agreements between Iran, Iraq, and Turkey. Framed as energy reliability coordination.
- **Refining and Petrochemical Upgrades:** Access to efficiency technology and emissions reduction systems. Framed as environmental modernization.
- **Strategic Reserve Swap:** Countries store fuel in each other's facilities, creating interdependence without political commitment. Framed as energy security cooperation.
- **Industrial Spare Parts Channel:** Controlled access to machinery and maintenance inputs for manufacturing. Framed as industrial continuity support.

Investment and Capital Access

- **Risk Guarantee Expansion:** World Bank Partial Risk Guarantee coverage increases with compliance milestones. Framed as investment de-risking.
- **Regional Infrastructure Fast-Track:** Pre-approved rail, port, and pipeline projects receive expedited financing. Framed as priority development pipeline.
- **Sovereign Credit Normalization:** Gradual improvement in credit ratings and borrowing access tied to compliance metrics. Framed as macroeconomic stabilization.
- **Diaspora Investment Channel:** Safe legal pathways for expatriates to invest in home-country projects. Framed as remittance optimization.

Technology and Knowledge Exchange

- **Academic and Technical Exchange:** Engineering, medical research, and nuclear safety cooperation. Framed as scientific cooperation.
- **Digital Infrastructure Access:** Cloud services and cybersecurity support. Framed as critical infrastructure protection.

- **Standards Alignment:** ISO compliance and financial reporting standards. Framed as global market compatibility.
- **Business Travel Facilitation:** Expedited visas for vetted commercial actors. Framed as trade enablement.

Multilateral Financial Institutions

IMF Macroeconomic Stability Facility

The IMF provides a \$5 billion standby credit line to ensure fragile states do not collapse economically during framework operation. Conditions include maintaining inflation at or below 10 percent, currency stabilization, framework compliance, and modest structural reforms. If conditions are met, the standby is available immediately during economic crisis. If violated, standby is suspended as a monitoring function, not a punitive measure.

Regional Development Bank

A dedicated regional development bank provides long-term project financing (20-30 year loans at concessional rates), currency swaps for trade settlement, trade finance, equity investment in major projects, and technical assistance. Capitalization: \$10 billion over three years. Lending capacity: \$10-15 billion annually.

Sovereign Immunity Waiver for Dispute Resolution

All framework participants agree to a limited sovereign immunity waiver applicable exclusively to arbitration and adjudication proceedings conducted under the framework's dispute resolution mechanism. The waiver covers:

- Arbitration tribunals established under the RCSA Dispute Resolution Protocol, with enforcement governed by the New York Convention or the ICSID Convention as applicable;
- Commercial disputes arising from framework-authorized transactions, including loan defaults under Regional Development Bank facilities, trade finance obligations, and investment protection agreements;
- Counter-claims and set-off defenses raised in good faith within the same proceedings, provided they arise directly from the framework relationship;
- Attachment or execution against commercial assets used in framework-related activity, excluding military property, diplomatic premises, and central bank reserves held for sovereign monetary functions.

The waiver does not extend to: (a) pre-judgment attachment without tribunal authorization; (b) criminal jurisdiction or extraterritorial regulatory enforcement; (c) third-party claims unrelated to framework obligations; or (d) assets designated as immune under bilateral investment treaties or international custom.

Any dispute over the scope of waiver application is resolved by the tribunal itself under the principle of kompetenz-kompetenz, with appeal to the Permanent Court of Arbitration for threshold jurisdictional rulings within 30 days.

Commercial Continuity Protection

Companies engaging in framework-authorized transactions receive:

- Sanctions reimposition escrow shield (24-month buffer)
- World Bank guarantee backstop (interest rate reduction)
- Regional Development Bank equity participation (10-20 percent stake sharing downside risk)
- Force majeure insurance (coverage for political violence, sanctions, government contract breach)
- Currency hedging support (exchange rate protection for projects in volatile currencies)

Regional Stabilization and Integration

The framework embeds a broader regional vision that extends beyond bilateral nuclear and economic matters. Regional modules activate as core bilateral compliance demonstrates viability.

Normalization Architecture

Normalization is treated as a structural element progressing from Day 1, not as a downstream result. For key actors, especially Saudi Arabia and the Gulf states, normalized relations represent the strategic dividend that makes comprehensive cooperation worthwhile.

Phase 0 Normalization Signals

- Existing Abraham Accord ties (UAE, Bahrain, Morocco) are consolidated and expanded within Phase 0
- Saudi overflight rights for civilian aircraft formally acknowledged
- Economic chamber-of-commerce observer status authorized
- Joint technical working groups on regional water and energy security convened

Phase 1 Normalization Acceleration

- Trade representation offices through third-country hosts
- Tourism corridor for specific traveler categories
- Academic exchange through university facilitation

The framework does not require Palestinian statehood as a condition for Saudi-Israeli normalization. It does require Saudi Arabia to publicly confirm its commitment to Palestinian humanitarian and development interests.

Burden-Sharing Architecture

The United States role is facilitator, guarantor, and dealmaker — not primary financier or long-term administrator:

- **Gulf States:** Fund Gaza reconstruction and Lebanon stabilization through dedicated funds, receiving proportionate governance and oversight roles
- **European Union:** Funds reconstruction in Syria, Lebanon, and Gaza through development mechanisms; provides civilian expertise

- **United States:** Provides security guarantees, diplomatic capital, intelligence support, and targeted financial facilitation
- **United Nations:** Manages humanitarian operations and monitoring architecture

Proxy Activity Management

The framework addresses proxy activity through a graduated architecture that distinguishes between levels of involvement and response:

Three-Tier De-escalation Zone Architecture

The framework establishes pre-authorized response bands that activate automatically upon confirmed incidents, providing credible deterrence without requiring case-by-case political authorization:

Table 17 Pre-Authorized Response Bands

Tier	Trigger	Immediate Response	Follow-On
Tier 1: Zone Violation	Banned weapons introduced to de-escalation zone	14-day naval patrol surge in affected maritime zone; enhanced radar and tracking	Governance body consultative session within 72 hours
Tier 2: Patterned Attack	Two or more confirmed attacks in 30 days in same theater	Suspension of next scheduled benefit tranche for 30 days; enhanced monitoring activation	Formal compliance review; remediation plan required within 14 days
Tier 3: Major Incident	50+ casualties or critical infrastructure attack	21-day crisis lock; attribution process; pre-authorized proportionate package	Ministerial-level review; binding arbitration option; potential benefit domain suspension

Operational Hardening (Edit 12): Under Tier 3 (Major Incident), the response includes a "21-day crisis lock" and "pre-authorized proportionate package." Notwithstanding the crisis lock, the targeted state's inherent right to self-defense under Article 51 of the UN Charter supersedes the 21-day crisis lock if an attack is ongoing and kinetic interception is required to save lives. In such circumstances, the state shall notify the governance body and guarantors within 2 hours of initiating kinetic interception, and the crisis lock shall be suspended in the affected theater for the duration of the active kinetic engagement.

Pre-Authorized Proportionate Packages

At framework entry, each party pre-commits to specific response measures that will activate upon confirmed Tier 3 attribution without requiring new political authorization. These measures are:

- **United States:** Pre-authorized suspension of next banking channel expansion; pre-authorized delay of next asset release tranche; pre-authorized enhanced naval presence (rotational, not new deployment)
- **Iran:** Pre-authorized suspension of next sanctions relief category; pre-authorized delay of next IAEA access expansion; pre-authorized reduction in transit toll rate

The key feature of pre-authorization is that these measures activate as a default consequence of Tier 3 attribution unless the governance body affirmatively votes to override. This creates a "presumption of response" rather than a "presumption of deliberation," ensuring that major incidents produce tangible consequences rather than indefinite process.

"Attributed-but-Uncontrolled" Doctrine

The framework recognizes that state control over semi-autonomous actors is rarely absolute. The "Attributed-but-Uncontrolled" doctrine establishes that a state remains responsible for proxy activity patterns even where direct command proof is unavailable. Responsibility attaches when:

- The proxy operates within territory or sphere of influence where the state exercises significant influence
- The proxy receives material, financial, or logistical support through channels linked to state institutions
- The state has capacity to constrain the proxy's activity but does not exercise that capacity
- A pattern of proxy activity has been established over multiple incidents, demonstrating organizational consistency

Under this doctrine, the evidentiary standard for framework consequences is "pattern-based attribution" rather than "command-and-control proof." A single incident does not trigger attribution. Three or more incidents within a 90-day period, demonstrating consistent methodology, target selection, or operational signature, may be designated a proxy pattern. The state is then responsible for using its influence to reduce the pattern, not for guaranteeing zero incidents.

Proxy Activity Cap System

Numeric thresholds are established for proxy activity in each framework-affected theater. These caps are not disarmament requirements; they are stabilization benchmarks that, when exceeded, trigger defined framework responses:

Table 20 Proxy Activity Cap Thresholds by Theater

Theater	Cap Metric	30-Day Threshold	90-Day Threshold
Lebanon-Israel Border	Cross-border incidents (rockets, infiltrations, IEDs)	2 incidents	5 incidents
Iraq (U.S. forces)	Attacks on military bases or convoys	1 incident	3 incidents
Red Sea Maritime	Vessel harassment or interdiction events	2 events	5 events
Gulf Maritime	Naval harassment or drone overflight	3 events	7 events
Yemen (Saudi/UAE)	Cross-border missile/drone launches	2 launches	5 launches
Syria (Israel)	Weapons transfer convoys or depot activity	1 confirmed transfer	3 confirmed transfers

Threshold breaches do not automatically trigger enforcement. They activate enhanced monitoring, require an explanatory briefing within 14 days, and contribute to the Compliance Indicators Score. Persistent threshold breaches (three consecutive 30-day periods above cap) activate the graduated enforcement ladder.

Mandatory Proxy Deconfliction Channels

The framework establishes direct or mediated communication lines with major non-state actors in each theater. These channels are not political recognition; they are operational safety mechanisms:

- **Lebanon:** UNIFIL-facilitated liaison between Israeli military liaison and relevant non-state actor representatives, with UNIFIL serving as message relay
- **Iraq:** Iraqi government-hosted coordination cell connecting U.S. military liaison, Iraqi security forces, and sub-state actor intermediaries for base proximity management
- **Yemen:** UN-led humanitarian coordination channel connecting Houthi representatives, Saudi/UAE military liaisons, and international maritime monitors for port and shipping deconfliction
- **Syria:** Russian-facilitated technical channel for airspace deconfliction, with notification protocols for military movements in proximity to framework-monitored zones

Channel operation is confidential. Channel existence is acknowledged publicly only as "operational safety mechanisms administered by the relevant international or host-nation authority." Messages transmitted through channels are not framework commitments and do not create obligations beyond operational safety.

Proxy Freeze Pilot Zones (Phase 0-1)

Rather than demanding comprehensive proxy cessation across all theaters simultaneously, the framework begins with 1-2 pilot zones where proxy activity is explicitly frozen as a confidence-building measure:

Pilot Zone 1: Southern Lebanon

- **Geographic scope:** Area south of the Litani River
- **Freeze commitment:** No offensive weapons introduction; no cross-border operations; no rocket launches
- **Verification:** UNIFIL + satellite monitoring + Lebanese Armed Forces patrol coordination
- **Duration:** 90 days, renewable by mutual consent
- **Benefit linkage:** Freeze renewal unlocks Lebanese economic emergency support tranche

Pilot Zone 2: Iraq Base Perimeter

- **Geographic scope:** 50-kilometer radius around designated U.S. and coalition bases
- **Freeze commitment:** No indirect fire attacks; no IED placement; no drone overflight
- **Verification:** Iraqi security forces patrol + U.S. base radar + commercial satellite
- **Duration:** 90 days, renewable
- **Benefit linkage:** Freeze compliance contributes to Iraq reconstruction fund disbursement

Pilot zones are not permanent solutions. They are testing grounds. If a pilot zone demonstrates 90 days of sustained compliance, it expands geographically. If compliance deteriorates, it contracts or is suspended without collapsing the broader framework.

Automatic Escalation Trigger for Mass-Casualty Events

To remove political hesitation under pressure, the framework establishes automatic triggers that bypass deliberation when mass-casualty events occur:

Table 21 Mass-Casualty Automatic Triggers

Severity Level	Trigger	Automatic Response	Political Override
Level 1: Significant	10-24 fatalities in single incident	Crisis Lock activation (14 days); emergency governance body session within 48 hours; enhanced monitoring in affected theater	Either party may request accelerated review; no veto on Lock activation
Level 2: Major	25-49 fatalities or critical infrastructure destruction	Crisis Lock (21 days); suspension of next benefit tranche in affected domain; fact-finding team within 72 hours; public attribution process initiated	Governance body may override tranche suspension by weighted majority within 7 days
Level 3: Catastrophic	50+ fatalities or mass-casualty attack on civilian target	Crisis Lock (30 days); domain-specific benefit freeze; full governance body ministerial session within 72 hours; pre-authorized proportionate package activation; UN Security Council notification by both parties	No override on Lock; benefit freeze may be lifted only by unanimous governance body vote after certified remediation plan

Automatic triggers are not punishment mechanisms. They are circuit breakers designed to prevent the political paralysis that has historically allowed mass-casualty events to escalate into wider conflicts. The triggers create immediate consequences that both parties can defend domestically: "The framework required this response; we did not choose it unilaterally."

Shock Response Envelope

The Shock Response Envelope is a pre-cleared, rapid-activation protocol designed to produce a framework-mandated response within 24 hours of a mass-casualty proxy event. It exists because domestic political pressure in democratic systems does not wait for attribution panels, governance body sessions, or dispute exhaustion. The envelope provides a framework-authorized response that both parties can defend to their publics as automatic and non-discretionary.

Envelope Triggers

Table 26 Shock Response Envelope Activation

Trigger Event	Confirmation Required	Response Window
Mass-casualty attack (25+ fatalities) attributed to a proxy force	Preliminary attribution by the Proxy Event Response Team (2 Iranian + 2 U.S. + 1 neutral)	24 hours
Attack on diplomatic or humanitarian personnel	Confirmed by ICRC or UN OCHA	12 hours
Use of chemical or biological agents	Confirmed by OPCW or WHO field team	6 hours
Attack on declared IAEA-monitored nuclear facility	Confirmed by IAEA incident report	4 hours

Pre-Cleared Response Menu

Upon envelope activation, the following measures activate automatically. The governing party (the state responsible for constraining the proxy) must select at least one measure from Column A within 24 hours. Failure to select triggers the automatic default from Column B.

Table 27 Shock Response Menu

Column A: Governing Party Actions (voluntary, within 24h)	Column B: Automatic Default (if Column A not selected)
Public condemnation of the proxy act by senior state official	Suspension of next scheduled benefit tranche in affected domain (30 days)
Arrest or detention of identified proxy operatives	Enhanced monitoring activation in all proxy-affected theaters (90 days)
Cutoff of known financial/logistical channels to the proxy	Freezing of next asset release tranche
Cooperative investigation with framework investigative team	Diplomatic demarche to all framework guarantors
Commitment to remediation plan with 14-day deadline	Compliance indicator score adjustment (+2.0 points)
Acceptance of enhanced monitoring in the affected theater	Public governance body statement noting non-cooperation

Key Design Principles

- **Speed over precision:** The envelope activates on preliminary attribution, not final proof. Final attribution continues through standard channels. If preliminary attribution is later reversed, Column B measures are lifted retroactively with compensation.
- **Framework ownership:** Responses are framework-authorized, not unilateral. This means: "The framework required this response" rather than "We chose to punish."
- **Proportionality ceiling:** No Shock Response measure may include military strikes, territorial sanctions, or population-level economic measures. The envelope is calibrated to be politically visible but operationally restrained.
- **Reversibility:** All Column B defaults are temporary (30 days maximum) and reversible upon remediation. They are designed to create pressure, not permanent damage.
- **Escalation brake:** Either party may request a 48-hour cooling-off period before Column B defaults activate. During the cooling-off, the guarantors attempt mediation. Only one cooling-off may be invoked per event.

Domestic Political Function

The Shock Response Envelope exists primarily to manage domestic political pressure. When a mass-casualty event occurs, publics demand response. Without a pre-cleared framework mechanism, leaders face a binary choice: unilateral retaliation (risking framework collapse) or no response (risking domestic political damage). The envelope creates a third option: framework-authorized, rapid, proportionate, reversible. This is the mechanism that makes the framework survivable under political shock.

Counterterrorism Integration

A dedicated counterterrorism compliance indicator is added to the scoring system, tracking cooperation on active extremist network intelligence, non-provision of safe passage to designated organizations, and participation in counterterrorism working groups. Active intelligence sharing is an unlockable Phase 1 benefit, creating positive incentive for cooperation rather than only compliance pressure.

Maritime Security Framework

Strait of Hormuz Governance

The framework establishes an International Hormuz Transit Authority with a three-tier tolling system. Toll revenue supports Iranian civilian reconstruction fund. Toll rates phase down as nuclear compliance milestones are reached. The Authority operates under neutral international management with representation from all littoral states.

Operational Hardening (Edit 9): IHTA Jurisdiction Definition. *The International Hormuz Transit Authority's jurisdiction is precisely defined as the maritime area bounded by: (a) the outer limit of the Iranian territorial sea (12 nautical miles from the baselines of the Iranian mainland and islands) on the northern and eastern boundaries; (b) the outer limit of the Omani territorial sea on the southern boundary; and (c) a line connecting Ras al-Hadd (Oman) to the Iranian coast at 25 degrees 40 minutes N, 57 degrees 20 minutes E on the eastern boundary. Within this defined international waters corridor, the IHTA exercises tolling authority. The IHTA has no tolling authority within the 12-nautical-mile territorial waters of any littoral state. Vessels transiting exclusively through territorial waters without entering the defined IHTA corridor are not subject to IHTA tolls, provided they do not transit the strait itself.*

Maritime De-escalation Protocols

- Maritime incident hotline: 2-hour response window
- Defined vessel harassment parameters: approach within 100 meters at speed; illumination; simulated attack maneuvers
- No-seizure zone in international waters: commercial vessels may not be seized without governance body notification and attribution process
- Agreed transit lane separation scheme

Operational Hardening (Edit 10): Toll Evasion Penalties. *If a commercial vessel refuses to pay the IHTA toll after being duly notified and invoiced through the Authority's electronic tolling system, the following enforcement mechanism applies: (a) the vessel's registry state and flag state are notified within 48 hours; (b) the vessel is denied port access in all framework-compliant states until the toll and any accrued administrative fees are paid; (c) the IHTA may register an international maritime lien against the vessel with the International Maritime Organization (IMO) registry, which must be satisfied before the vessel may clear any port in a framework participant state; (d) kinetic interception for toll enforcement is explicitly prohibited; enforcement is exclusively through port-access denial and maritime liens. The lien accrues interest at 0.5 percent per month until satisfied.*

Red Sea Maritime Security

If Houthi de-escalation is achieved, an International Maritime Convoy System provides escort of commercial vessels through the Red Sea. A Bab-el-Mandeb inspection regime involves random inspection of vessels for weapons smuggling, conducted by a Djibouti-hosted multinational team with inspectors from all major parties.

Operational Hardening (Edit 11): Red Sea Security Linkage — Punitive Counterbalance. *The existing incentive structure (25% toll reduction for 60 days of Hudaydah port compliance) is supplemented by a punitive counterbalance: any confirmed Houthi anti-ship missile launch against commercial or military vessels in the Red Sea, Bab-el-Mandeb, or Gulf of Aden automatically applies a 50 percent "Risk Premium" surcharge to the IHTA toll for all Yemen-linked shipping for 30 days. This surcharge is calculated on the full standard toll rate (before any reductions) and is non-waivable except by unanimous governance body vote. The Risk Premium creates immediate regional economic pressure against anti-ship attacks by imposing a direct cost on Yemen-linked maritime commerce. Revenue from the Risk Premium is directed to the Yemen Reconstruction Fund (not to the Iranian civilian reconstruction fund) to ensure the surcharge functions as a stabilizing penalty rather than a revenue generator for any conflict party.*

Mediterranean Maritime Protocol

The Mediterranean Sea represents a secondary maritime domain of concern. While Iran maintains limited naval presence in the Mediterranean with occasional vessel transits through the Suez Canal, no special protocol is required beyond standard UNCLOS provisions. Should Israel-Iran managed competition advance to Phase 2 or beyond, additional protocols addressing naval presence near coastal areas may be developed by mutual agreement and governance body consensus.

Non-State Actor Transformation

The framework provides structured pathways for non-state armed actors to transition from paramilitary status to political or civilian integration, reducing the proxy activity that drives regional instability.

Integration Pathway Principles

- Voluntary participation with verified compliance milestones
- Economic incentives tied to concrete behavioral changes, not political statements
- International monitoring of integration process to prevent re-militarization
- Graduated legal status changes reflecting demonstrated compliance

Regional Conflict Stabilization Modules

The framework addresses active conflict theaters through modular annexes that activate based on theater-specific conditions. Each module operates independently; progress in one theater is not conditioned on progress in others. The following sections summarize the operative architecture for the three highest-priority theaters.

Yemen Stabilization Framework

The Yemen module is mandatory at framework entry, addressing the conflict that has produced the region's worst humanitarian crisis and directly threatens Red Sea maritime security.

Yemen Mini-Framework Architecture

The Yemen module includes four operative pillars:

- **Ceasefire Verification:** A UN-led monitoring mission verifies cessation of hostilities across agreed lines of control. Verification includes: satellite monitoring of military positions; drone surveillance of frontlines; UN team spot-checks; and hotline reporting from all parties. Ceasefire violations are logged in a real-time incident registry accessible to all framework parties.
- **Port and Airport Access:** Hudaydah port operates under UN-certified humanitarian inspection with 48-hour maximum vessel clearance. Sana'a airport opens for medical evacuation and humanitarian flights with pre-cleared passenger manifests. Aden port operates without restriction for humanitarian and commercial goods. Revenue from all ports flows to a monitored escrow account.
- **Phased Territorial Stabilization:** Territory is divided into stabilization zones based on security conditions. Zone A (safe): full humanitarian access and civilian governance restoration. Zone B (transitional): UN-monitored local administration with joint security patrols. Zone C (contested): active conflict zone with humanitarian corridor protection only. Progression from Zone C to B to A is based on verified security metrics, not political timelines.
- **Dual Authority Transition Model:** An interim governance structure operates for 24 months, combining Houthi-administered civil service functions with internationally recognized government oversight of revenue, foreign policy, and major appointments. The interim structure is not permanent; it is a bridge to elections or a negotiated power-sharing agreement. Both authorities retain their external legitimacy positions while sharing operational governance.

Revenue-Sharing Mechanism

Oil and port revenues are split via a monitored escrow managed by a neutral financial institution (proposed: a major Swiss bank). The split is: 40 percent to Houthi-administered zones for civil service salaries and basic services; 40 percent to internationally recognized government zones; 20 percent to a Yemen Reconstruction Fund administered by the World Bank with equal oversight from both authorities. Revenue sharing is conditional on verified ceasefire maintenance in revenue-producing zones.

Operational Hardening (Edit 1): Ceasefire Violation Thresholds. A "formal ceasefire violation" is defined as any of the following: (a) three or more confirmed hostile incidents (including but not limited to indirect fire, direct fire engagements, sniper fire, or drone strikes) within a single 72-hour period in any revenue-producing zone; (b) a single incident causing 5 or more civilian casualties in a revenue-producing zone; (c) confirmed movement of heavy weapons (tanks, artillery, missiles) into prohibited zones; or (d) deliberate obstruction of UN monitoring team access to ceasefire lines. Isolated incidents (one or two confirmed events within 72 hours, such as rogue sniper fire or unauthorized small-arms discharge) are logged as "ceasefire friction events" and do not constitute a formal violation. Upon formal violation designation, the 40/40/20 escrow disbursements are automatically frozen pending governance body review within 7 days. The freeze is lifted only upon certification by the UN monitoring mission that hostilities have ceased and heavy weapons have returned to previously verified positions.

UN-Led Disarmament Sequencing

Heavy weapons are managed through a graduated sequence: heavy weapons (tanks, artillery, missiles) are moved to monitored storage sites under UN and joint authority supervision within 90 days of ceasefire entry. Medium weapons (mortars, RPGs, heavy machine guns) are registered and tagged within 180 days. Small arms remain with registered security forces pending a political settlement on permanent security architecture. Disarmament is sequenced, not instantaneous, and is linked to verified compliance at each stage.

Operational Hardening (Edit 2): Disarmament Enforcement Clause. Failure to move heavy weapons (tanks, artillery, missiles) to UN-monitored storage sites within the 90-day deadline constitutes a material delay in the Yemen stabilization module. In the event of such failure: (a) the 40 percent Houthi civil service salary disbursement from the escrow account is automatically suspended, effective on Day 91; (b) the suspension continues until the UN monitoring mission certifies that at least 75 percent of declared heavy weapons have been moved to monitored storage; (c) during suspension, humanitarian port and airport access continues uninterrupted, but infrastructure investment tranches linked to disarmament compliance are frozen; (d) the governance body convenes within 14 days of Day 91 to assess whether the delay reflects genuine logistical constraints (in which case a one-time 30-day extension may be granted by neutral chair concurrence) or deliberate obstruction (in which case the suspension stands and the compliance indicator score is adjusted by +1.5 points).

Dual Authority Transition — Deadlock-Breaking Mechanism

The 24-month interim governance structure combines Houthi-administered civil service functions with internationally recognized government oversight of revenue, foreign policy, and major appointments. Both authorities retain their external legitimacy positions while sharing operational governance.

Operational Hardening (Edit 3): Deadlock-Breaking Mechanism. *Where the internationally recognized government and Houthi administrators cannot reach consensus on "major appointments" (defined as: provincial governors; central bank board members; port authority directors; and military zone commanders) within 21 days of formal nomination, the UN Special Envoy to Yemen holds a binding tie-breaker vote. The Special Envoy must consult both parties in writing before casting the tie-breaker, and the decision must be issued within 7 days of the consultation period. The tie-breaker vote is final and not subject to appeal within the Yemen module governance structure, though either party may refer the appointment to the framework governance body for advisory review (non-binding) within 14 days. This mechanism prevents governance paralysis from stalling the 24-month transition without requiring either party to accept the other's nominee unilaterally.*

Red Sea Security Integration

Yemen stabilization is directly linked to maritime benefits. If Hudaydah port operates without interference for 60 consecutive days, the International Hormuz Transit Authority toll rate for Yemen-linked shipping is reduced by 25 percent. If maritime incidents originate from Yemen territory, the governance body may suspend toll benefits and refer the matter to the Yemen stabilization working group. This creates a direct economic incentive for maritime compliance without requiring political normalization.

Iraq Stabilization and Militia Integration

The Iraq module addresses the challenge of integrating sub-state armed groups into a unified national security architecture while protecting existing force presence and preventing factional conflict.

PMF Integration Pathway

The framework supports a structured pathway to convert Popular Mobilization Forces into Iraqi National Guard or reserve units. The pathway is voluntary, not mandatory; PMF factions choose whether to integrate.

Operational Hardening (Edit 4): PMF Integration Deadline. Notwithstanding the voluntary nature of the pathway, a hard 18-month deadline applies from framework entry into force. PMF units that refuse to enter Stage 1 (Registration) by Month 18 are legally designated as unlawful combatants by the Iraqi state under Iraqi domestic law and forfeit all framework amnesty protections. Units entering Stage 1 by Month 18 retain amnesty eligibility regardless of subsequent integration progress. The 18-month deadline is non-extendable except by unanimous governance body vote, which may grant a single 6-month extension only upon verified evidence that logistical capacity (not political will) prevented registration. The Iraqi Ministry of Defense shall publish a public registry of registered units and a separate list of non-registered units at Month 18, with the latter list transmitted to all framework parties and guarantors.

Integration stages:

- **Stage 1 (Registration):** PMF units register with Iraqi Ministry of Defense, providing unit rosters, equipment inventories, and command structure documentation. Registration does not require disarmament.
- **Stage 2 (Audit):** Parallel chain-of-command audit maps who actually controls which forces. The audit is conducted by Iraqi government inspectors with international technical assistance. It identifies: units under Iraqi government command; units with dual loyalty; and units operating outside any recognized chain of command.
- **Stage 3 (Integration):** Government-command units transition to National Guard status with state payroll, standardized equipment, and Ministry of Defense operational authority. Dual-loyalty units enter a 12-month transitional status with joint command arrangements. Unaffiliated units are subject to disarmament-or-departure requirements.
- **Stage 4 (Consolidation):** All integrated units operate under unified Iraqi command. Foreign advisory presence is reduced to training and technical support roles.

Operational Hardening (Edit 5): Dual-Loyalty Relocation Requirement. In Stage 3, units designated as having "dual loyalty" (defined as receiving command input from both the Iraqi Ministry of Defense and an external political or military authority) enter a 12-month transitional status with joint command arrangements. During this 12-month transitional period, these units are required to physically relocate to bases outside their traditional strongholds (minimum 100 kilometers from their current primary base). The relocation is monitored by the Iraqi Ministry of Defense with UN technical assistance. The purpose of relocation is to disrupt localized extortion networks, sever territorial control relationships, and demonstrate submission to national command. Failure to complete relocation within 12 months results in automatic loss of transitional status and reclassification as unaffiliated units subject to disarmament-or-departure requirements. The Iraqi government commits to constructing or designating sufficient alternative base capacity to accommodate relocated units.

Militia Salary Normalization

A critical driver of militia loyalty is economic. The framework supports shifting PMF funding from informal channels (political party budgets, foreign transfers, extortion) to formal state payroll systems. The Iraqi government commits to: budget transparency for all integrated units; direct bank deposit for registered personnel; and international audit of salary flows. In return, framework partners provide technical assistance for payroll system modernization and agree not to designate Iraqi state institutions for sanctions based on normalized salary payments.

Base Protection Compact

Joint rules govern proximity between U.S., Iraqi, and militia forces:

- 50-kilometer base perimeter zones where offensive weapons are restricted
- Pre-notification protocols for troop movements within 20 kilometers of designated facilities
- Incident reporting hotline connecting U.S. base command, Iraqi security forces, and registered PMF liaison officers
- Automatic investigation of any incident within base perimeters, with findings published to the governance body

Operational Hardening (Edit 6): *Base Protection Compact — Automatic Payroll Deduction. The 50-kilometer base perimeter rule is supplemented by an automatic financial enforcement mechanism: any indirect fire (mortar, rocket, or drone attack) originating from within a registered PMF unit's designated sector results in an immediate, automatic deduction from that specific unit's state payroll allocation. The deduction equals 25 percent of the monthly payroll for the unit for the first verified incident, 50 percent for the second incident within 90 days, and full suspension of state payroll for the third incident within 90 days. The deduction is calculated by the Iraqi Ministry of Defense and applied within 15 days of incident confirmation by the joint incident investigation team. Payroll deductions are redirected to a Base Protection Compensation Fund for injured personnel and infrastructure repair. A registered PMF unit may appeal the deduction within 14 days to the governance body Dispute Resolution Sub-Committee, but the deduction remains operative during appeal.*

Gradual Disarmament Incentives

Economic and political integration is tied to verified compliance. PMF units that register, accept audit, and enter transitional status unlock: Iraqi government salary guarantees; infrastructure investment in their home provinces; and vocational training programs for personnel seeking civilian employment. Units that complete full integration are eligible for participation in Iraqi security sector governance and international peacekeeping training.

Syria De-escalation and Stabilization

The Syria module rejects the premise that nationwide political settlement must precede stabilization. Instead, it builds stability zone by zone, creating facts on the ground that reduce conflict intensity and enable eventual political negotiation.

Phased Ceasefire Map

Syria is divided into stabilization zones based on current control and security conditions:

- **Zone 1 (Daraa/South):** Government-controlled, relatively stable. Target: full humanitarian access, refugee return facilitation, local governance restoration.
- **Zone 2 (Coastal/Rural Damascus):** Government-controlled with residual opposition. Target: conditional return, demining, basic service restoration.
- **Zone 3 (Aleppo/North):** Mixed control, Turkish influence. Target: cross-line humanitarian access, trade corridor opening, civilian protection.
- **Zone 4 (Northeast):** Kurdish-led administration. Target: service provision, anti-ISIS coordination, border management.
- **Zone 5 (Idlib/Northwest):** HTS-controlled, high risk. Target: humanitarian corridor only, no return, no reconstruction until security conditions change.

Each zone has independent stabilization metrics. Zone 1 can advance to full reconstruction while Zone 5 remains humanitarian-only. Progress in one zone is not hostage to progress in another.

Operational Hardening (Edit 7): Idlib Mass-Displacement Protocol. Zone 5 (Idlib) is designated for "humanitarian corridor only, no return, no reconstruction." In the event that hostilities flare within Idlib and produce mass-displacement events (defined as 10,000 or more internally displaced persons within a 72-hour period), the following protocol activates automatically: (a) Zone 3 (Aleppo/North) is mandated to accept IDPs up to a threshold of 50,000 persons, with UNHCR establishing emergency camp capacity within 48 hours; (b) if Zone 3 capacity is exceeded, Zone 2 (Coastal/Rural Damascus) is mandated to accept up to 30,000 additional IDPs; (c) the governance body convenes within 24 hours of mass-displacement confirmation to coordinate cross-line humanitarian access and security guarantees for IDP corridors; (d) no framework party may block IDP movement to the designated receiving zones; (e) reconstruction funding for receiving zones is accelerated by 25 percent during the displacement period to absorb population pressure. This protocol ensures that mass-displacement events do not produce ad hoc border crises or political hostage-taking.

External Actor Drawdown Matrix

A sequenced approach to reducing foreign military presence:

Table 22 External Actor Drawdown Sequence

Actor	Phase 0 Action	Phase 1 Action	Phase 2 Action	Phase 3 End State
Iran	Freeze new deployments	Reduce advisory personnel 25%	Transition to diplomatic presence only	Normal state-to-state relations
Turkey	Freeze territorial expansion	Begin border area civilian handover	Reduce military observation posts	Security cooperation agreement
Russia	Maintain air defense	Transition to airbase-only posture	Reduce ground advisory presence	Technical military cooperation
U.S.	Maintain counter-ISIS presence	Shift to advisory-only in NE	Reduce to special operations support	Intelligence cooperation only

Operational Hardening (Edit 8): Iran Advisory Personnel Baseline. The requirement that Iran reduce advisory personnel by 25% in Phase 1 is operationally meaningless without a verified baseline. Prior to Phase 0 entry, a neutral third-party verification team (composed of personnel from guarantor states and UN military observers) shall conduct a confidential baseline assessment of Iranian advisory personnel in Syria. The baseline assessment shall document: (a) the total number of Iranian military advisors and IRGC-affiliated personnel in Syria; (b) their locations by facility and province; (c) their functional roles (training, command, logistics, intelligence). The baseline report is deposited with the governance body secretariat and shared with all framework parties. The 25% Phase 1 reduction is calculated against this verified baseline. A follow-up verification assessment is conducted at Month 12 to confirm reduction. Without a verified baseline conducted prior to Phase 0, no Phase 1 reduction certification may be issued, and associated benefits (including sanctions relief micro-tranches linked to Syria drawdown) remain frozen.

Reconstruction-for-Compliance Model

International reconstruction aid is tied to verified local stability, not national political conditions. Each zone receives reconstruction funding proportionate to: ceasefire maintenance (40% weight); humanitarian access guarantee (30% weight); and local governance functionality (30% weight). Funding is disbursed through the World Bank with independent monitoring. Zone-specific sanctions relief micro-tranches unlock as zones meet stability benchmarks.

Local Governance Compacts

Municipal-level agreements replace national-solution-first approaches. Each zone establishes local governance compacts between: community representatives; existing administrative structures; and international technical assistance providers. Compacts address: security provision; service delivery; property rights; and dispute resolution. International recognition of local compacts is provisional and does not confer sovereignty or statehood status.

Israel-Iran Direct Deconfliction Layer

While Israel is not a formal framework party, its quiet cooperation or active opposition is determinative for framework viability. The 2015 JCPOA experience demonstrated that sustained opposition contributed to framework erosion. This section provides Israel-adjacent provisions that address core concerns without granting formal veto authority.

Direct Deconfliction Protocol

The framework establishes three direct deconfliction domains between Israel and Iran, mediated through the guarantor architecture:

- **Airspace:** Pre-notification of military flights within 100 kilometers of either party's territory; 72-hour notice for exercises or deployment movements; automatic hotline activation for airspace proximity incidents
- **Maritime:** Mediterranean and Red Sea naval presence notifications; agreed separation distances for naval vessels; incident reporting through Oman-mediated channel
- **Cyber:** No-notification channel for critical infrastructure attack attribution; 48-hour response commitment for "critical infrastructure" flagged communications; independent technical assessment of major cyber incidents

Shadow Conflict Ceiling

The framework defines "unacceptable escalation thresholds" that apply to covert as well as overt operations:

Table 23 Shadow Conflict Thresholds

Domain	Threshold	Automatic Framework Response
Nuclear Facilities	Any attack on declared IAEA-monitored sites	Crisis Lock (30 days); immediate ministerial session; IAEA emergency inspection; UN Security Council notification
Critical Infrastructure	Attack causing >48-hour disruption of water, power, or healthcare systems serving >100,000 civilians	Crisis Lock (21 days); enhanced monitoring; joint technical assessment
Leadership Targeting	Confirmed assassination of senior government or military officials	Crisis Lock (14 days); attribution process; UN Secretary-General notification
Commercial Maritime Shipping	Sinking or seizure of civilian vessels in international waters	IHTA security activation; emergency protocol; naval patrol surge

Operational Hardening (Edit 14): *Cyber Threshold Hardening. The 48-hour disruption threshold for critical infrastructure is reduced to a 12-hour disruption threshold for power and healthcare systems. A 48-hour hospital blackout constitutes a mass-casualty event in itself, and the framework recognizes that 12 hours is the maximum tolerable disruption for power grids serving >100,000 civilians and for hospital systems in conflict-affected areas. Water systems retain a 24-hour threshold (intermediate between 12 and 48 hours) reflecting storage capacity realities. The revised thresholds apply to both cyber and kinetic attacks on critical infrastructure.*

Third-Party Strike Buffer Rule

To prevent automatic retaliation loops: any attack attributed to a third party (not a framework core party) triggers a 72-hour attribution confirmation period before any framework party may take retaliatory action. During the buffer period: intelligence is shared through guarantor channels; the Proxy Event Response Team (2 Iranian, 2 U.S., 1 neutral expert) convenes; and the guarantors issue a preliminary attribution assessment. Retaliatory action before buffer expiration is considered a unilateral act outside framework authorization and may trigger framework suspension procedures.

Operational Hardening (Edit 13): Third-Party Strike Buffer Reduction. The 72-hour attribution buffer for third-party strikes is reduced to 12 hours for active, continuous missile/drone barrages (defined as three or more projectiles launched within a 6-hour period with ongoing threat to life or critical infrastructure). During active, continuous barrages, targeted states retain the right to immediate counter-battery fire and active defense measures without awaiting full attribution confirmation. The 12-hour reduced buffer applies exclusively to kinetic self-defense and counter-battery operations; broader retaliatory measures (including strikes on suspected launch sites or supply depots) remain subject to the standard 72-hour buffer unless the ongoing barrage creates an imminent threat to civilian population centers, in which case the Article 51 override in Edit 12 governs. All counter-battery fire under the 12-hour exception must be reported to the governance body and guarantors within 2 hours.

No Strategic Surprise Commitment

The framework establishes a binding commitment that neither party will undertake actions that fundamentally alter the strategic landscape without prior notification. This commitment addresses the destabilizing effect of sudden, unilateral strategic moves that have historically collapsed diplomatic processes.

Notification Requirements

The following categories of action require advance notification through the Tier 3 Leadership Reset Hotline:

- **New military deployments:** Introduction of combat forces exceeding 500 personnel to any framework-affected theater requires 14-day advance notification
- **Facility establishment:** Construction or activation of new military installations in framework-monitored zones requires 30-day advance notification
- **Major weapons system introduction:** Deployment of ballistic missile batteries, advanced air defense systems, or strategic weapons platforms requires 14-day advance notification
- **Alliance restructuring:** Entry into new mutual defense arrangements affecting framework-affected theaters requires 30-day advance notification

Notification Content

Notifications must include: the nature of the planned action; estimated timeline; geographic scope; and stated objective. Notifications are not requests for permission; they are commitments to transparency. The receiving party may request clarifying information within 7 days but may not veto the action.

Surprise Response Protocol

If a party undertakes a covered action without advance notification:

- The action is not retroactively prohibited; the framework does not create a veto
- However, the failure to notify constitutes a Tier 2 compliance concern
- Compliance indicator score is adjusted by +1.0 point
- Governance body convenes within 14 days to assess whether the action alters the strategic equilibrium
- If the governance body determines by weighted majority that the action constitutes a strategic surprise, the affected party may activate a 30-day Stabilization Hold on non-core obligations in the affected domain

Exclusions

The surprise commitment does not apply to: emergency defensive measures in response to imminent attack; covert operations that, if disclosed, would compromise operational security (notification required within 48 hours of operation completion); humanitarian emergency deployments; and routine personnel rotations within existing facilities.

Strategic Stability Review

Every 90 days, the governance body conducts a Strategic Stability Review assessing whether cumulative notified actions are producing a strategic shift that requires framework recalibration. The review is non-binding but informs phase transition decisions and benefit timing.

Counterterrorism Integration Upgrade

Joint Designation Review Mechanism

The framework establishes a process for aligning (or managing differences in) terrorist designations between parties. A Joint Designation Review Panel meets quarterly to: review new designation requests from either party; assess shared intelligence on extremist networks; and publish agreed designations while recording disagreements without blocking cooperation on shared threats. Disagreed designations do not block cooperation on agreed threats. The Panel's mandate covers ISIS, Al-Qaeda affiliates, and regionally active extremist networks.

Operational Hardening (Edit 15): Fusion Cell Intelligence Firewall. Intelligence shared within the optional Intelligence Fusion Cell regarding an agreed-upon threat (e.g., ISIS) cannot be used to target a disagreed-upon entity (e.g., a specific regional militia). This strict firewall operates as follows: (a) all intelligence shared in the Fusion Cell is tagged by contributing parties with a "scope classification" (agreed threat vs. contested entity); (b) intelligence tagged as related to an agreed threat may be used for joint operational planning against that threat only; (c) intelligence tagged as related to a contested entity may be received and recorded but may not form the basis for any kinetic or sanctions action against that entity by a party that does not share the designation; (d) any party that uses Fusion Cell intelligence to target a contested entity in violation of this firewall is subject to an immediate 2.0-point compliance indicator penalty and suspension of Fusion Cell participation for 90 days; (e) the firewall is enforced by the neutral guarantor hosting the Fusion Cell, which maintains access logs and audits compliance. The firewall ensures that tactical intelligence cooperation on shared threats is not weaponized for strategic disagreements.

Intelligence Fusion Cell (Phase 1 Optional)

An optional Intelligence Fusion Cell activates in Phase 1, hosted by a neutral guarantor state. The Cell provides: shared threat data on ISIS, Al-Qaeda, and regional extremist networks; independent analysis of attack attribution; early warning of extremist mobilization; and coordinated response planning. Participation is voluntary for all parties. Data sharing is sanitized to protect sources and methods. The Cell does not share intelligence that could be used against framework parties' domestic political interests.

Safe-Passage Prohibition Tracking

The framework monitors movement of extremist fighters across borders through: biometric registration at border crossings in framework-affected zones; Interpol-linked watchlist coordination; and satellite tracking

of known transit routes. Verified safe-passage provision by any framework party or affiliated actor is treated as a Tier 2 proxy compliance concern and triggers the graduated enforcement ladder.

Arms Control Expansion

Regional Missile Transparency Regime

A voluntary missile transparency mechanism requires pre-notification of: ballistic missile tests (72-hour notice, including range and trajectory); cruise missile deployments (14-day notice for new basing); and major exercises involving missile systems (7-day notice). Notifications are published through the governance body secretariat and shared with all framework parties. Non-notification does not trigger enforcement but is recorded in the transparency register and may affect compliance scoring.

Air Defense Coordination Rules

To prevent misidentification and accidental escalation: all parties commit to ADS-B transponder use for military aircraft in framework-monitored airspace; radar coordination protocols for overlapping air defense coverage zones; and 48-hour pre-notification for air defense system activation in border regions. These rules reduce the risk that defensive air defense systems trigger offensive responses.

Cyber Non-Attack Norms

The framework establishes agreed prohibitions on cyber attacks against: nuclear facilities (operational or research); hospitals and healthcare systems; financial systems and central bank infrastructure; water and power grid control systems; and aviation navigation and air traffic control. Violations are treated as material breaches under the enforcement ladder. The governance body maintains a Cyber Incident Registry documenting all reported violations and remediation efforts.

Regional Arms Registry (Phase 2)

A voluntary regional arms registry activates in Phase 2, requiring disclosure of: major weapons systems (tanks, aircraft, naval vessels) above agreed thresholds; ballistic and cruise missile inventories; and chemical/biological defense capabilities. Disclosure is voluntary and does not require complete inventories. Partial disclosure is accepted. The registry builds transparency gradually, with incentives (trade facilitation, investment access) linked to participation depth.

Crisis Management and Communication

The framework establishes redundant communication channels and crisis protocols to prevent the accidental escalation that has historically undermined regional agreements.

Three-Tier Communication Architecture

Tier 1: Military Deconfliction Hotline

A 24/7 direct line between U.S. CENTCOM and Iranian Armed Forces operations centers. Purpose: immediate de-escalation of military incidents; prevention of accidental engagement; maritime, airspace, and ground incident response. Response times: 2 hours for maritime incidents, 4 hours for airspace, 6 hours for ground incidents.

Tier 2: Technical Implementation Hotline

Secure channel between Technical Implementation Officers, coordinated through governance secretariat. Purpose: technical problem resolution; verification continuity maintenance; compliance data clarification. Response times: 24 hours for urgent matters (verification gaps), 72 hours for standard matters.

Tier 3: Leadership Reset Hotline

Direct encrypted line between U.S. Secretary of State and Iranian Foreign Minister, with Oman-mediated relay fallback. Purpose: framework-stall intervention; political-level reset; strategic reassessment. Response time: 4 hours for any message marked "Reset Protocol." Reserved for framework-stall situations only.

Humanitarian Deconfliction Hotline

Managed by UN OCHA, connecting humanitarian coordinators, military liaisons, and civil administrations. Purpose: notify of humanitarian movement; prevent military interference with corridors; coordinate medical evacuation. Response time: 1-hour acknowledgment; 4-hour coordination response.

Crisis Lock and De-escalation

When any hotline reports a major incident, a Crisis Lock may be activated. The Lock is designed to create breathing room for assessment before escalation, but it is also protected against weaponization by bad-faith actors.

Triggers

- 10+ fatalities involving party nationals
- Verified direct military clash between parties
- Imminent destabilization from either party's assessment
- Critical infrastructure attack
- Verification system integrity alert

Effects

- 14-day freeze on all status-quo changes
- Governance body emergency session within 48 hours
- Fact-finding team deployed within 72 hours
- No prejudice from Lock-period actions
- Extension by governance body majority vote, maximum 42 days total

Anti-Abuse Safeguards

The following mechanisms prevent the Crisis Lock from becoming a tool for strategic paralysis:

- **Frequency Limit:** No party may trigger more than one Crisis Lock per 90-day period. Any additional trigger within 90 days is logged but does not activate a new freeze unless approved by the neutral chair with written justification.
- **Escalating Cost:** A party that triggers a Crisis Lock that is subsequently determined to have been based on fabricated or exaggerated claims faces: (a) a 1.0-point compliance indicator procedural penalty; (b) loss of Crisis Lock triggering privilege for 180 days; (c) mandatory public correction of the trigger claim.
- **Default Action During Lock:** While the Crisis Lock freezes status-quo changes, it does not freeze: (a) humanitarian corridor operations; (b) IAEA monitoring activities; (c) banking channel transactions below \$10 million; (d) medical evacuations. These activities continue under "protected operations" status.
- **Lock Override:** If the governance body determines by weighted majority that a Crisis Lock is being abused to stall implementation, the Lock may be lifted early with 24 hours' notice. The party that triggered the Lock may appeal to the guarantors, but the override remains operative pending guarantor review.

Third-Party Shock Absorber

Following a third-party attack or spoiler event: 30-day no-penalty window activates automatically; mandatory joint investigation by Proxy Event Response Team (2 Iranian, 2 U.S., 1 neutral expert); if

attribution inconclusive after 30 days, event is classified as non-attributable with no penalties and cooperative threat mitigation only.

Regional Incident Firewall

If a regional incident (not directly involving framework parties) threatens to escalate: automatic governance body notification within 4 hours; bilateral consultation within 24 hours; coordinated public statement within 48 hours. This prevents independent military responses to third-party events.

Communication Redundancy

To ensure hotline survivability during cyber attacks or system failures:

- Primary: Encrypted digital channels (multiple platforms)
- Secondary: Secure satellite phone links
- Tertiary: Oman-mediated relay (diplomatic pouch and in-person if electronic systems fail)
- Quaternary: Swiss protecting power channel (if diplomatic relations suspended)

All hotlines are tested monthly on the first Monday of each month. Failed tests trigger technical remediation within 48 hours. Results are included in quarterly transparency summaries.

Enforcement and Dispute Resolution

The framework's enforcement system is designed to be politically translatable to domestic audiences while maintaining operational precision. It provides simplified deterrence statements for public communication and detailed graduated mechanisms for operational management.

Graduated Response Framework

The canonical enforcement ladder applies to all compliance concerns across all domains. No party may escalate from one step to the next without exhausting all mechanisms at the current step. A Certificate of Exhaustion issued by the governance body is required before activating higher steps.

For proxy and security incidents, the pre-authorized response bands described in the Regional Stabilization section operate in parallel with this ladder. Pre-authorized measures activate as a default upon confirmed Tier 2 or Tier 3 attribution, subject to governance body override by weighted majority. This ensures that security incidents produce tangible consequences through automatic triggers rather than requiring case-by-case political deliberation.

Figure 6 — Graduated Response Framework

Four-step escalation with mandatory exhaustion requirements between steps. Step 1 (Clarification): compliance concern recorded, 14-day context window, no consequences. Step 2 (Technical Consultation): formal consultative session, written brief, enhanced monitoring for 90 days. Step 3 (Ministerial Review): formal assessment, compliance indicators adjusted, benefit suspension up to 45 days. Step 4 (Proportionate Response): targeted partial suspension, snapback friction ladder with 44-day minimum interval. Certificate of Exhaustion required before activating higher steps.

Figure 6: Graduated Response Framework

Step 1: Clarification

The governance body records a compliance concern and invites the implicated party to provide context within 14 days. No economic or security consequence. Compliance indicators may be updated to reflect the inquiry. Working-level consultation convenes within a reasonable period.

Governs: Technical lapses under 30 days; single-incident anomalies; first pattern-of-concern designation.

Step 2: Technical Consultation

The governance body convenes a formal consultative session. The implicated party provides a written explanatory brief. Technical experts may be convened. No automatic economic consequence, but enhanced monitoring activates for 90 days. Benefit timing may be reviewed.

Governs: Technical lapses 30-45 days; second pattern-of-concern designation.

Step 3: Ministerial Review

The governance body issues a formal compliance assessment at ministerial level. Compliance indicators are formally adjusted. Next scheduled benefit may be suspended for up to 45 days pending resolution. Both parties retain benefits accrued to date. Neutral chair concurrence required. Public statement may be issued.

Governs: Technical lapses over 45 days; confirmed breach of non-core obligation; three pattern-of-concern designations in 12 months.

Step 4: Proportionate Response

Targeted partial suspension of benefits in the breached domain only. Nuclear breach leads to nuclear-related benefits review. Security breach leads to security-linked measures review. Cross-domain escalation requires governance body supermajority and neutral chair concurrence. Snapback friction ladder activates with minimum 44-day interval from warning to full suspension. No instant reimposition. Orderly failure protocol activates with 90-day re-engagement window.

Governs: Confirmed material breach; systematic non-cooperation; compliance score at 12.0+; formal repudiation.

Tier Priority Labels

Every mechanism is assigned one of three priority tiers:

- **Tier 1 (must survive in any version):** Nuclear cap compliance; monitoring; ceasefire; humanitarian access; transit governance; governance body existence; core definitions
- **Tier 2 (negotiable, conditional):** Benefit timing; proxy freeze specifics; border arrangement pathway; regional burden-sharing ratios; normalization acceleration
- **Tier 3 (optional, context-specific):** Modular programs; technology cooperation; tourism corridors; detailed reconstruction governance

Gray-Zone Management

Actions that do not constitute material breaches but undermine framework purpose are addressed through defined gray-zone banding:

Table 8 Gray-Zone Incident Banding

Band	Description	Response
Band 1: Monitoring	Single isolated incident; technical explanation plausible	Governance body records incident; no consequence
Band 2: Consultation	Two or more related incidents without clear attribution	Consultative session; no economic consequence; factual record produced
Band 3: Response	Three or more incidents with credible attribution forming pattern	Formal finding; benefit delay up to 30 days; enhanced monitoring; public statement option
Band 4: Escalation	Cumulative or serious; approaches formal compliance concern	Referred to standard breach response process

False Positive Protection

If a violation finding is subsequently demonstrated incorrect, benefit delays are restored retroactively with economic value made whole. The finding is annotated in the Precedent Registry. No compliance indicator points from the false-positive finding are retained.

Verification Abuse Guardrail

To protect against excessive inspection requests: complementary access inspections are capped at five per year at standard review levels; requests above the cap require governance body majority approval; inspection requests without specific technical basis are returned for supplementary justification; Iran may designate up to five sensitive-period windows per year with extended notice. Cumulative delay may not exceed 72 hours for declared sites.

Election Quiet Period

A formal "Quiet Period" activates during major national elections, legislative blockage, or executive constraint. Effects: new obligation activation paused; existing obligations continue without breach classification; benefits continue at 50 percent; escalation actions suspended; monitoring and governance body operation continue; deadlines paused. Maximum one Quiet Period per 12-month period per party; maximum 60 days without governance body approval.

Tiered Arbitration Architecture

The dispute resolution system replaces fully binding arbitration as the first recourse with a tiered system that is more politically acceptable and historically more likely to produce durable compliance.

Stage 1: Advisory Determination

The Joint Technical Panel issues a non-binding advisory determination on any dispute unresolved through governance body consultations. Findings are published in the Transparency Summary. Either party may publicly note its view without triggering compliance consequence.

Stage 2: Binding Determination (Mutual Opt-In)

If both parties agree in writing within 30 days of a Stage 1 determination to accept binding arbitration, a three-person panel is constituted: one party-appointed arbitrator each, one chair from the standing neutral pool. Panel decisions are final and binding.

Stage 3: UN Secretary-General Reference

If Stage 2 is not invoked but the dispute remains unresolved and pertains to a core obligation, either party may refer the matter to the UN Secretary-General for non-binding recommendation. The recommendation is published. Either party may decline without framework collapse.

Costed Withdrawal

While withdrawal is permitted and does not constitute bad faith, it is not consequence-free:

- Withdrawal from a module suspends associated benefits effective from notice receipt
- Benefits accrued up to notice date are retained
- 30-day governance body review assesses whether withdrawal reflects compliance concern, political will gap, or operational failure
- Minimum 30 days' notice for module withdrawal; 12 months for full framework withdrawal
- Re-entry available after 30-day re-baseline period with governance body certification

Orderly Failure Protocol

If the framework collapses, ordered reversion applies rather than unmanaged crisis:

- IAEA monitoring of declared facilities continues under existing safeguards agreement
- Humanitarian access channels remain open at pre-framework levels under UN mandates
- Transit continues under UNCLOS freedom of passage
- Commercial Continuity Protection for certified contracts continues for 24 months
- 90-day re-engagement window during which no new escalatory actions are taken
- Diplomatic continuity channels remain operational

Detention, Hostage, and Detainee Resolution Mechanism

The Detention, Hostage, and Detainee Resolution Mechanism (DHRM) is a core framework track operating from Day 1, co-equal with nuclear, economic, and humanitarian tracks. Hostage issues are not side deals; they are central stabilizers that build trust through demonstrated reciprocity. The mechanism covers all detention categories across framework-affected theaters: Gaza, Lebanon, Iraq, Syria, and Iran.

Three-Tier Hostage Exchange Model

Exchanges are staged by priority tier, preventing deadlock through graduated progress:

Table 24 Hostage Exchange Tiers

Tier	Category	Priority	Timeline
Tier 1	Women, children, elderly, wounded, medical emergencies	Immediate	Days 1-14 (First exchange window)
Tier 2	Civilian adult detainees; dual nationals; humanitarian workers	High	Days 15-60 (Second exchange window)
Tier 3	Military and security detainees; prisoners of war; complex cases	Conditional	Days 60-180 or Phase 1 (Third exchange window)

Rolling Exchange Windows

Instead of one massive all-or-nothing deal, the framework operates continuous small-batch releases tied to compliance cycles:

- **Exchange Window 1:** Days 7-14. Tier 1 releases. Verified by ICRC. Count: 5-10 releases per batch minimum.
- **Exchange Window 2:** Days 21-30. Tier 1 completion, Tier 2 initiation. Count: 10-20 releases.
- **Exchange Window 3:** Days 45-60. Tier 2 completion. Count: 15-25 releases.
- **Exchange Window 4:** Days 75-90. Tier 3 initiation if conditions permit. Count: case-by-case.

Ongoing Cycle: Every 30-day review cycle, the DHRM working group reviews new cases, proof-of-life status, and exchange readiness.

Rolling windows prevent all-or-nothing collapse and deny political opponents a single moment to sabotage. Progress is incremental and often invisible, reducing the political stakes of each release.

Hostage-for-Benefit Trigger Mechanism

Exchanges are linked to framework benefits through carefully calibrated triggers that incentivize cooperation without rewarding hostage-taking:

- **Tier 1 exchange completion unlocks:** enhanced humanitarian corridor capacity; medical supply priority routing; and ICRC access expansion
- **Tier 2 exchange completion unlocks:** banking channel transaction limit increase; asset release schedule acceleration; and reconstruction fund pre-positioning
- **Tier 3 exchange completion unlocks:** sectoral sanctions relief tranche; civilian aviation access; and academic exchange normalization

Anti-Incentive Safeguard

The value of benefits unlocked per release is capped at a level that does not make hostage-taking economically rational. The framework explicitly states that hostage-taking for the purpose of unlocking benefits is a material breach that triggers immediate enforcement. New hostage-taking after framework entry voids all pending exchange benefits for the responsible party.

Humanitarian Decoupling Clause

Even if exchange negotiations fail or stall, the following protections remain operative:

- Medical access to all detainees continues through ICRC without conditions
- Proof-of-life verification continues on 30-day cycles
- Family communication rights are maintained
- Legal representation access is guaranteed
- Humanitarian conditions (food, water, shelter, sanitation) are monitored

This decoupling prevents detainees from being used as pure leverage assets. Their humanitarian treatment is not contingent on exchange success.

Multi-Theater Detainee Registry

A centralized Detainee Registry covers all framework-affected theaters:

- **Gaza Track:** Israeli-held Palestinian detainees; Palestinian-held Israeli detainees; civilian internees
- **Iran Track:** Dual nationals held in Iran; Iranian nationals held abroad
- **Lebanon Track:** Cross-border detainees from 2006 conflict and subsequent incidents
- **Iraq Track:** ISIS-affiliated detainees; security detainees; missing persons from conflict
- **Syria Track:** Political detainees; missing persons; children in detention

The Registry is maintained by the ICRC with framework secretariat support. It is not public to protect detainee security but is accessible to all framework parties and guarantors. Registry entries include: identity; detention status; legal classification; health condition; and exchange eligibility.

Universal Detention Categories

The framework standardizes detention terminology to eliminate semantic manipulation:

- **Hostage:** Civilian held for political leverage; detention is the primary objective
- **Detainee:** Person held pending legal process or security assessment; detention is protective or investigative
- **Prisoner of War:** Military combatant captured during armed conflict; governed by Third Geneva Convention
- **Missing Person:** Individual whose fate is unknown; may be alive, deceased, or detained
- **Civilian Internee:** Civilian detained for security reasons in occupied territory; governed by Fourth Geneva Convention

Classification determines applicable protections, exchange sequencing, and legal status. Disputes over classification are resolved by the ICRC with governance body oversight.

Proof-of-Life Protocol

Mandatory verification requirements:

- Initial proof-of-life within 7 days of framework entry for all registered detainees
- Renewed proof-of-life every 30 days for Tier 1; every 60 days for Tier 2; every 90 days for Tier 3
- Proof-of-life includes: video confirmation (minimum 30 seconds); medical status report; and approximate location verification (city or district level)
- Failure to provide proof-of-life within required windows triggers: ICRC escalation; governance body notification; and potential compliance indicator adjustment

Third-Party Custody Option

For high-risk exchanges where direct handover poses security concerns to either party, the framework provides a third-party custody mechanism:

- Detainees are transferred to ICRC or guarantor-state custody at a neutral location (Geneva, Muscat, or Islamabad)
- Third-party custody lasts 24-72 hours maximum
- During custody, ICRC verifies identity, health status, and voluntary consent for transfer
- Final release occurs only after both parties confirm receipt of their respective exchanged individuals

Third-party custody reduces last-minute deal collapses and security fears during transfer.

Hostage-Taking Deterrence Clause

If new hostage-taking occurs after framework entry:

- Automatic suspension of the specific benefit category most recently unlocked by the responsible party
- Immediate compliance escalation to Step 2 (Technical Consultation)
- ICRC and governance body investigation within 72 hours
- Existing exchange process for previously detained individuals continues uninterrupted
- New cases are added to the Registry and treated as separate matters

The clause is designed to deter new hostage-taking without harming current detainees. It creates a clear cost for the behavior while protecting ongoing humanitarian processes.

Force Posture Transition Architecture

The framework replaces the concept of "withdrawal" with "force posture transition" — a structured reduction of visible military footprint tied to verified compliance milestones rather than political timelines. The transition is framed as mission completion, not retreat.

Reframing Withdrawal as Mission Completion

All references to force reduction use transition language:

- **Mission Transition Declaration:** Withdrawal is triggered not by "leaving" but by "completion of defined stabilization benchmarks." A joint body certifies: maritime security stabilized; nuclear monitoring restored; proxy activity reduced to agreed thresholds; and host-nation capacity certified. Only then does drawdown begin.
- **End of Emergency Deployment Status:** The region is formally declared to no longer require surge-level presence. This is politically powerful for leadership: it asserts success, not concession.
- **Rotational Presence Normalization:** Carrier and troop deployments shift to standard global rotation cycles rather than emergency surges. This looks routine, not reactive.
- **Over-the-Horizon Readiness:** The United States declares that rapid response capability remains offshore (Indian Ocean, Diego Garcia, etc.) even as visible footprint decreases. Deterrence is maintained without permanent basing.

Regional Troop Ceiling Ladder

Table 25 Regional Force Posture Transition by Country

Country	Baseline	Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	End State
Iraq	2,000-2,500	1,200	600	300	200-300
Syria	900-2,000	600	600	300	0-100
Kuwait	13,000+	9,000	5,000	2,500	Logistics + prepositioned equipment
Qatar	10,000	8,000	6,000	4,000	Persistent regional HQ
Bahrain	7,000	6,000	5,000	4,000	Naval presence + reduced support
UAE	3,500	2,500	1,500	800	Air access + intelligence
Saudi Arabia	2,000-3,000	1,500	1,000	500	Air defense cooperation
Jordan	2,000-3,000	2,000	1,200	600	Training + contingency staging

Total Regional Reduction: Current ~40,000-50,000 → Phase 1: ~30,000-35,000 → Phase 2: ~20,000-25,000 → Phase 3: ~10,000-15,000.

Transition Mechanisms

Base Consolidation First

Rather than immediate exit from all locations, the framework reduces from approximately 19 sites to core hubs only. This maintains operational capability during transition while reducing visible footprint. Consolidation precedes drawdown: sites are closed in order of operational redundancy, with functions transferred to remaining hubs.

Mission Conversion Pathway

Combat roles transition to advisory roles; advisory roles transition to technical support roles; technical roles transition to periodic rotational presence. Each conversion requires host-nation capacity certification. Iraqi forces must meet readiness benchmarks before U.S. combat advisors withdraw. Syrian Kurdish forces must demonstrate anti-ISIS autonomous capacity before counterterrorism support reduces.

Automatic Drawdown Incentive Link

As compliance improves, troop levels automatically decrease. The link is not punitive; it is celebratory. Each drawdown is announced as proof that the framework is working. This creates a positive incentive structure: compliance produces visible, politically beneficial troop reductions that leaders can claim as achievements.

Carrier Decongestion Trigger

If major maritime incidents are absent for 90 consecutive days, carrier presence automatically reduces from surge levels (3 carriers) to normal rotation (2 carriers) to standard presence (1 carrier). This trigger is not a withdrawal commitment; it is a risk-based adjustment. If incidents resume, carrier presence can increase through the same automatic mechanism.

Maritime Security Handover

Responsibility for Red Sea and Gulf maritime security transitions from U.S.-led to multinational maritime force with U.S. as supporting participant. The transition is staged: Phase 1 — U.S. leads with regional escort participation; Phase 2 — regional forces lead with U.S. advisory support; Phase 3 — multinational command with U.S. as participant. This preserves maritime security while reducing U.S. operational burden.

Regional Security Substitution

As U.S. forces transition, regional actors and UN/multinational forces fill gaps. The framework provides: security sector training and equipment; intelligence sharing agreements; and rapid response option agreements (U.S. capability remains available within 72 hours if requested). This ensures allies do not feel abandoned while the U.S. reduces permanent footprint.

Reversible Drawdown Safeguard

If major compliance failure occurs after drawdown, limited temporary reintroduction is permitted. The framework explicitly preserves: prepositioned equipment stocks; access agreements for rapid re-entry; and intelligence infrastructure that does not require permanent basing. This reassures security stakeholders without blocking the transition pathway.

Key Annexes Summary

The framework contains multiple annexes addressing specific functional domains. The following summary provides reference for the scope and activation conditions of each annex.

Table 9 Annex Activation Matrix

Annex	Subject	Activation	Status
A	Core Layer Obligations Summary	Phase 0	Mandatory
B	Humanitarian Baseline Metrics	Phase 0	Mandatory
C	Joint Implementation Group Charter	Phase 0	Mandatory
D	Contingency Triggers and Fallback Pathways	Phase 0	Mandatory
M	Hezbollah Disarmament and Integration	Phase 2 or 3	Optional
N	Houthi De-escalation and Integration	Phase 2 or 3	Optional
O-P	Iraqi Political and Militia Integration	Phase 2 or 3	Optional
Q	Israel-Iran Deconfliction	Phase 2 essential; Phase 0/1 optional	Optional
R	Syria Stabilization	Phase 3 essential; Phase 2 optional	Optional
S	Regional Economic Integration and Infrastructure	All phases	Highly recommended
T	Counterterrorism Cooperation	Phase 3 essential; Phase 1/2 optional	Optional
U	Humanitarian and Refugee Architecture	Automatic at Phase 0	Optional
V	Multi-Domain Arms Control	Phase 3 essential; Phase 2 optional	Optional
W	Thirty Vital Improvements and Governance Reform	With core	Mandatory
X	Unauthorized Action Response	With core	Mandatory
Y	Naval Crisis Management	Upon carrier deployment	Mandatory
Z	Nuclear Stabilization Integration	With Phase 0	Mandatory

AA	Hostage Exchange and Detainee Recovery	Phase 0 or 1	Optional
BB	Lebanon-Israel Border Demarcation	Phase 2 or 3	Optional
CC	Gaza Governance and Reconstruction	Phase 1+	Optional
DD	Regional Proxy and Militia Freeze	Phase 1+	Optional
EE	Red Sea Maritime Security	Phase 1+	Optional
FF	Iraq Militia Freeze and Force Protection	Phase 1+	Optional
GG	International Hormuz Transit Authority	Phase 1+	Optional
HH	Treaty Resilience and Institutional Continuity	With core	Mandatory
II	Phased Foreign Troop Withdrawal	Phase 2+	Optional
JJ	Regional Economic Incentive Architecture	All phases	Optional
KK	Kurdistan Regional Governance Compact	Phase 2+	Optional
LL	Trilateral Stability Architecture	Phase 2 or 3	Optional
NN	Domestic Opposition Management	All phases	Optional

Notable Annex Descriptions

Annex Z: Nuclear Stabilization Integration

A mandatory companion to Phase 0, establishing a three-site architecture (Fordow, Natanz, Isfahan), a 15-day review cycle system, and a four-phase nuclear pathway. Full integration of facility conversion protocols and monitoring continuity provisions.

Annex HH: Treaty Resilience and Institutional Continuity

Mandatory protocol addressing technical lapse procedures, treaty survival in institutional collapse, preliminary stabilization instruments, liaison offices, Pakistan as joint guarantor, precedent registry, dual-speed interpretation, and weighted majority standards. Also establishes a 15-year oil moratorium architecture and compliance cost symmetry mechanisms.

Annex GG: International Hormuz Transit Authority

Three-tier tolling system with Iranian civilian reconstruction fund allocation, maritime de-escalation protocols, vessel seizure procedures, and toll phase-down linked to nuclear compliance milestones.

Annex JJ: Regional Economic Incentive Architecture

Twenty compliance-linked economic incentives with \$300+ billion decade impact. Phase 0 quick-wins of \$15+ billion; Phase 1 boom of \$58+ billion. Designed to make defection cost-prohibitive through constituency pressure.

Annex LL: Trilateral Stability Architecture

Addresses Israel-Lebanon-Hezbollah dynamics through a calibrated 15-point framework with review cycle integration. Includes parallel unilateral steps for asymmetric actor handling and a tripartite monitoring mechanism anchored to national forces. Activates in Phase 2 or Phase 3 by governance body consensus.

Annex NN: Domestic Opposition Management

Provides mechanisms for managing internal political opposition to framework participation. Includes legislative safeguard provisions, bipartisan quorum engineering, lobbying transparency registry, neutral information hub, disinformation countermeasures, crisis lock for proxy incidents, defense sector pivot mandates, and compliance simulation tools. These provisions are designed to protect the framework from internal sabotage without restricting legitimate democratic deliberation.

Appendices

Appendix A: Canonical Core Definitions

Breach. A confirmed failure to perform a specific obligation on its due date, verified by the governance body. A breach is distinct from a Technical Lapse and from a pattern-of-concern designation. Not every violation constitutes a breach; not every breach is material.

Material Breach. A breach that fundamentally undermines the purpose of the specific provision. Requires governance body determination, not unilateral characterization.

Technical Lapse. A delay of up to 45 days in meeting a scheduled milestone where core obligations are still being performed and the delay is logistical or administrative. Does not constitute breach and does not activate enforcement unless uncured after 45 days.

Stabilization Hold. A time-limited pause in new obligation activation (not existing obligation performance), triggered by either party for up to 30 days (renewable to maximum 120 consecutive days). Not a breach and does not constitute bad faith.

Quiet Implementation Mode. A mode in which public announcements about implementation are reduced or batched, without altering substance of obligations, verification, or oversight. Active for maximum 45 consecutive days.

Proportionate Response. A consequence limited in scope to the domain and severity of the triggering event. Disproportionate responses require governance body authorization and neutral chair concurrence.

Appendix B: Rapid Results Layer (Days 0-30)

The Rapid Results Layer produces publicly visible, headline-ready deliverables within 30 days of entry into force. Its purpose is to create immediate domestic political cover, demonstrate framework viability, and generate momentum for longer processes.

Table 10 Rapid Results Milestones

Day	Milestone	Verification
Day 3	Humanitarian surge: all corridors confirmed open; 200+ tons delivered	UN OCHA reporting
Day 7	Pilot asset release: \$50 million to Iranian Central Bank	Dual bank confirmation
Day 10	Civilian nuclear cooperation terms announced	Simultaneous government statements
Day 14	Medical isotope research exchange delegation convened	Neutral venue attendance
Day 21	Tier 1 humanitarian banking channel operational	First confirmed transactions
Day 30	First governance body plenary session	Public statement issued

Appendix C: Implementation Sequencing Matrix

Table 11 Phase 0 Sequencing (Days 1-180)

When	Event	Responsible Party	Trigger for Next Step
Day 1	Framework entry into force; governance body convenes	Governance body	Executive signatures
Day 1-7	Humanitarian corridor activation	UN OCHA, Egypt, Israel	Corridor verified open
Day 7	Pilot asset release (\$50M)	U.S. Treasury, Iranian CBI	Dual bank confirmation
Day 14	Nuclear facility declaration complete	Iranian AEOI, IAEA	IAEA confirms receipt
Day 21	Humanitarian banking channel operational	U.S. Treasury, Iranian CBI	First transactions
Day 30	First governance plenary; Tranche 1 relief formally declared active	Governance co-chairs	Phase 0 declared
Day 45	IAEA baseline inspection complete	IAEA, Iranian AEOI	Baseline report issued
Day 90	Tranche 2: banking + asset release; first review cycle close	Governance body	Compliance score published
Day 180	Phase 0 Gate Review	Ministerial review	Phase 1 option or extension

Appendix D: Documentation and Modification Guide

This framework document is constructed for modular extension and amendment. The following conventions facilitate future modification:

- **Section IDs:** All sections carry unique HTML identifiers (e.g., id="sec-nuclear") for direct linking and cross-referencing
- **Data Labels:** All figures and tables use data-label attributes for automatic numbering
- **Modular Annexes:** Each annex is designed as a self-contained module that may be added, removed, or modified without affecting core provisions
- **Priority Tiers:** All mechanisms are labeled Tier 1 (essential), Tier 2 (conditional), or Tier 3 (optional) to guide negotiation prioritization

- **SSOT Layer:** Core definitions and enforcement hierarchies are maintained in a Single Source of Truth layer that takes precedence over annex-specific provisions

Modifications to this document should preserve the hierarchical conflict resolution principles and maintain institutional binding provisions. All amendments require governance body consensus for structural changes; procedural adjustments may be approved by working-level consultation.

Document Structure for Future Editors

This HTML document uses semantic sectioning with clear heading hierarchies (h1 for major sections, h2 for subsections, h3 for detailed provisions). CSS classes are applied consistently: .info-box for summary callouts, .highlight-box for important principles, .overview-box for multi-element summaries. Charts are embedded as PNG images with figure captions. Tables use three-line styling with thead and tbody separation. All content is contained within the body element with no external dependencies beyond the assets folder.

Appendix E: Key Terms and Abbreviations

Table 12 Abbreviations and Terms

Term	Definition
AEOI	Atomic Energy Organisation of Iran
CBI	Central Bank of Iran
CIS	Compliance Indicators System
FTO	Foreign Terrorist Organization
IAEA	International Atomic Energy Agency
ICRC	International Committee of the Red Cross
IHTA	International Hormuz Transit Authority
IMF	International Monetary Fund
IRGC	Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps
JIG	Joint Implementation Group
LEU	Low Enriched Uranium
MICI	Investor Confidence Index
NPT	Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of Nuclear Weapons
OCHA	UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs
OFAC	Office of Foreign Assets Control (U.S. Treasury)
PMF	Popular Mobilization Forces (Iraq)
PRG	Partial Risk Guarantee
RCC	Regional Coordination Council
SDF	Syrian Democratic Forces
SNSC	Supreme National Security Council (Iran)
SWIFT	Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication
UNHCR	UN High Commissioner for Refugees
UNIFIL	UN Interim Force in Lebanon
WASH	Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene
WFP	World Food Programme
WHO	World Health Organization

Appendix F: Document Control and Extension

This document is designed for operational use and iterative extension. Future editors should observe the following protocols:

Section Modification

All sections carry persistent identifiers for stable cross-referencing. When adding new sections, use the format sec-[subject] for section IDs and fig-N or table-N for figure and table references. Numbering should follow sequential order within each category.

Annex Addition

New annexes may be added using the next available letter designation. Each annex must specify: subject matter, activation phase, mandatory or optional status, and relationship to existing annexes. New annexes should be registered in the Annex Activation Matrix (Table 9) and cross-referenced in the Table of Contents.

Amendment Tracking

Material amendments to core provisions require governance body consensus. Technical clarifications may be issued as interpretive guidance without formal amendment. All interpretations are recorded in the Precedent Registry maintained by the governance secretariat.

Distribution

This document is intended for: senior negotiators, technical implementation officers, legal and compliance officers, governance body secretariat staff, and authorized third-party guarantors. Distribution beyond these circles requires governance body authorization.

Notice: This is a condensed reference edition of a broader framework architecture. For comprehensive operative text, consult the full master document and applicable annexes. This edition prioritizes accessibility and professional presentation over exhaustive procedural detail.